

CONFERENCE '71

**Twenty-First
Annual Meeting
of the
General Service
Conference
of
Alcoholics Anonymous**

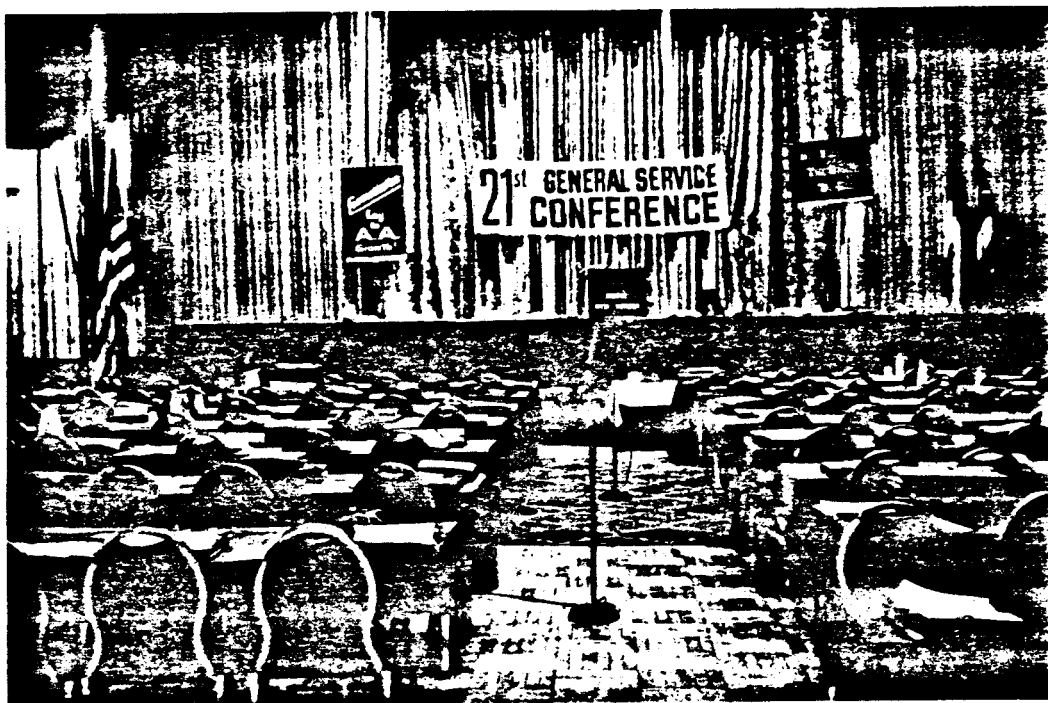
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Communication: Key to A.A. Growth

— Conference Theme

An A.A. member may order a copy of this report through his G.S.R. or other group officer. Traditionally, all members have the right of access to information about all phases of A.A.'s General Services. This report is "confidential" only because in it certain members must be identified by name. The "confidential" designation protects the personal anonymity of such members at the public level.

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Conference at a Glance

COMMUNICATION SEEN AS KEY TO A.A. GROWTH

Bill's Work Continues

A fitting memorial to our co-founder Bill is that we who remain do our best to keep the Fellowship of Alcoholics Anonymous safe, vital and unified for all those yet to come, Margaret C., Area Delegate Chairman, told delegates to the 21st General Service Conference.

"Our first impulse is to say we need him still, even if it is just to know that his wisdom and knowledge is here," she said, noting that "those of us who have learned to see and to hear with our hearts know that Bill is still present."

Margaret said that those who have had the tremendous privilege to have lived in this first generation of Alcoholics Anonymous and to have known Bill, now have an equally great responsibility to continue the work that he and Dr. Bob started.

Bern Smith Remembered

At the same time Margaret expressed gratitude for the life of Bernard Smith and noted a deep sense of personal loss at the passing of this beloved, nonalcoholic trustee "who loved the spiritual oneness upon which this Fellowship is based so much that he gave over 25 years of service to help create the structural oneness that will keep us strong."

Don F., West Central Regional Trustee, who delivered the key note speech at the conference, told delegates that we must seek newer more effective means of communications in order to carry the message of recovery to the still suffering alcoholic.

At the same time Don pointed out that a recent Public Information survey discovered that while A.A. as an organization is held in high regard, 54% of those interviewed thought its membership was composed of weak, unhappy and neurotic people. "Now if that is the image that people have of the membership of A.A., maybe we had better try to correct it if we can," he said.

GROUPS and MEMBERS

Spring 1971

	Groups	Members
United States	9,541	167,167
Lone Members . .		146
Canada	1,667	25,957
Lone Members . .		51
In Hospitals	767	18,604
In Prisons	925	32,481
Internationalists . .		412
	12,900	244,818
Overseas*	3,559	66,632
Totals	16,459	311,450

*1970 count, until Part II of the *World Directory* is published in August 1971.

(including non-reported members, actual membership is estimated at more than 500,000 worldwide.)

"Dr. Bob is gone, Bern is gone and now Bill is gone," Don continued. "And I'm sure all three of these men at sometime or other were faced with the timeless problem of mortality — the comfortable retreat or the arduous advance, without the prospect of personal reward.

"That is the same problem all of us at A.A. must decide today," Don said. "I think I know what the decision will be. That this wonderful fellowship of A.A. — of the drunk, by the drunk and for the drunk shall not perish from this earth."

IN MEMORIAM

Bill W., Co-founder, died Jan. 24, 1971, Miami Beach, Florida.

Bernard B. Smith, non-A.A. trustee since 1944, died July 31, 1970, New York City.

Bill W., Panel 20 delegate, Alberta, Canada.

Hugh S., Panel 19 delegate, Nova Scotia/Nfld./Labr.

Advisory Actions of '71 Conference

New York, April 24 — Delegates to the 21st Annual General Service Conference which ended here today were guided by the theme: **COMMUNICATION: KEY TO A.A. GROWTH**, in discussing ways and means to more effectively carry the message of recovery to the still suffering alcoholic.

Present at the five and one-half day conference at the New Yorker were 90 delegates representing groups from every state and province in the United States and Canada. During this period they attended an almost continuous series of meetings, discussions and workshops at which they explored ways and means of improving communications both within A.A. and with our friends outside.

Delegates, together with alcoholic and non-alcoholic General Service Board Trustees, A.A.W.S. and Grapevine directors and staff members form the 129-member Conference which acts on behalf of the Fellowship to provide guidance to the Board, G.S.O. and Grapevine. Some Conference highlights:

GRAPEVINE — Gave approval to the Grapevine Corporate Board to raise the price of the Grapevine from 35¢ to 50¢ for a single copy, and from \$3.50 to \$5 for a yearly subscription, "if the trend of rising costs indicates that the need is there."

AGENDA/ADMISSION — Recommended that the two-year moratorium on applications by the areas for additional delegate representation be terminated.

INSTITUTIONS — Recommended support for G.S.O. efforts to establish an Institutions Correspondence Service on an individual basis, similar to the Loner-Sponsor Service.

POLICY — Recommended formation of a Conference Committee on Professional Relations to correspond with the Trustees' Committee on Professional Relations. This will make a total of ten Conference committees,

(See p. 36 for full list of actions.)

IN MEMORY OF BILL

This 21st annual meeting of the General Service Conference is the first at which our beloved Bill is not with us. It is thus a sad and solemn occasion. Yet, it is also one which marks the time when our Fellowship of Alcoholics Anonymous must truly come of age. We can no longer turn to the physical presence of our co-founder for the guidance which he gave to us in such great measure throughout his lifetime.

There was a meeting of the Board a few days after Bill died. And during the discussion of one matter there were a few points of disagreement. When it reached a certain level of intensity, I found myself waiting to hear Bill speak up and say those few words that would put everything in perspective. But he didn't speak. And it was then brought forcibly home to me that we would never hear his voice again—that we could no longer count on the ever-presence of his wisdom and strength. We could never again say as we had so many times before, "Let's see what Bill thinks about it."

To be perfectly honest, I still have not yet come to accept this completely. I do believe in my heart that Bill is here with us at this very moment. He has left us with an integral part of himself in this General Service Conference which makes up the voice of A.A.'s group conscience worldwide. I think that it stands and meets today as one measure of his greatness and vision of the future.

As I see it, Bill was the good sponsor, the wise oldtimer—willing to let go of us before we were willing to let go of him. This was not only because he wished us all the greatest good, but because he had an abiding faith in the fact that our Fellowship not only could, but should, run without him.

I know that Bill believed that the wisdom of A.A. was to be found in the group conscience—that it came out of church basements and not from the pulpit; that it was directed from the groups up through the delegates and the Conference structure, rather than the other way around. Bill knew that it was not one voice that should be heard, but many thousands of voices: and it was his gift that he was able to listen to them all and out of the noise and confusion discern the group conscience. Then he would say something and all the rest of us would exclaim, "Why, yes, of course, that's it." And what Bill's death means to me now is that all of us—me, the other trustees and staff and delegates—will all have to listen much more carefully than we once did in order to make out the voice of the group conscience.

I know this is possible, for this was Bill's vision—one that he lived to see fulfilled—to create a channel of communication within the Fellowship of Alcoholics Anonymous that would make it possible for all to be heard—from the individual through the group, to the delegates and to the trustees so that A.A. will always be here to extend a helping hand to the still-suffering drunk who is crying out in the night for help.

Those of us meeting here today are a part of that channel of communication—and have been. Yet I think that it is only now that we can truly begin to grasp the great responsibility that is ours. Now it is we who must listen and act upon the voice of the group conscience. While the responsibility is great, however,

I do believe that we can meet it—through the Steps and Traditions and Concepts; through the legacies of Recovery, Unity and Service, and, yes, through the simple slogans we clung to in our own early days of recovery.

We have all of this, but in order to survive and prosper we need but one thing more. And that is the help of God. I ask for it now—that He give us knowledge of His will and the power to carry it out.

In closing, I would like once more to give thanks to God that Bill lived and did so much to make this world a better place for all of us.

—John L. Norris, M.D., chairman
General Service Board

Loss of Bern Smith: Beloved Nonalcoholic Trustee

God gave us Bill — and now He has taken him away. How does one express in the coldness of words what is in the hearts and minds of us who almost literally have found life because this Fellowship was here?

As we shared our loss, several of you said what a tremendous privilege it had been to live in the first generation of Alcoholics Anonymous and to have had the opportunity to know Bill personally. Then one of you quickly added, "...but because we have had that great privilege, we now have an equally *great responsibility*."

One of you said that from now on, you would always see Bill in the face of a newcomer as it took on life and beauty and awe at the wonder of it all. You said many beautiful things about Bill, but mostly you said very simply, "We are so grateful that he lived."

And you went on to express gratitude for the life of Bernard Smith and a deep sense of personal loss at the passing of this beloved nonalcoholic trustee. Bern Smith loved the spiritual "oneness" upon which this Fellowship is based, so much that he gave over twenty-five years of service to help create the structural "oneness" that will keep us strong. For his life, too, we are very grateful.

Bill will not walk down the aisle this year — or in future years — to sit among us. But, through the gift that God gave to him to give to us, we have learned to see with more than our eyes, and to hear with more than our ears. We have learned to see and to hear with our hearts — and our hearts *know* that Bill is here.

Let this then be our memorial to Bill — that our General Service Conference always hold this fully matured gift, Alcoholics Anonymous, in loving, oh so gentle hands — keeping it safe, vital and unified — for all those yet to come.

—Margaret C., chairman
Area Delegates

COMMUNICATION: KEY TO A.A. GROWTH

If there was ever a time in the history of the world when there was an abundance of communication, it surely must be now; at a time when, with the most sophisticated instruments, we not only see but talk to our men on the moon at the time they are landing on the moon. We can see as well as hear a speech given before Parliament in London as the speech is being given.

But with all our sophistication, we seem to have arrived at a very low level of communication in many areas: father with son, pupil with teacher, police with citizen, and black with white.

Search for Answers

I am not here today to talk about the world at large, but only about communication as it applies to A.A. within and without. As we know, we must keep our lines of communication open within or we will surely die. Let's move on to the communication outside A.A. How best can we tell the "good news" of recovery to the still-suffering alcoholic? Because I'm more familiar with my own search for these answers, I'll try briefly to recount part of it. It might be called the anatomy of one drunk's search for FREEDOM.

My first clue came dramatically while still a boy in high school, watching the movie, "Dr. Jekyll and Mr. Hyde." The horrible effect the potion Dr. Jekyll drank had on him, though more dramatic, was similar to the effect booze had on someone in my own family. I used to ponder: Why, with a negative reaction like this, would anyone ever try it again? Little did I know then of the cunning, baffling aspects of John Barleycorn. I was 17 years old, and had already developed a deep hatred for, and an antagonism toward drinking. Little did I think I could or would ever fall a victim to the malady myself.

My second clue came at about the age of 22 from a book, "One Man's Meat Is Another Man's Poison." I had reached a place in life where my drinking was causing some trouble, and I was already what could be called a potential alcoholic. I don't think anyone or anything could have interested me in sobriety, and I wanted no advice.

My third clue came via *Colliers* magazine about 1938. I was 27 years old by then and had a wife and two young children. This article was written by an alcoholic telling of the utter futility he had experienced over a long period of time, trying to recapture the glow from booze he had attained at one time. I was a full-fledged alcoholic myself by then, and I, too, had experienced this *exercise in futility*. To my knowledge, this was the first written word of another alcoholic I had ever read and oh, how I identified with him!

My fourth clue came in 1941 with the S.E.P. article by Jack Alexander about this wonderful thing called A.A. I had been sober about 18 months, but the story excited and interested me very much. I continued on this sober period for another 18 months and seven days. Then I went on the drunk of drunks, covering a two-week span of horror.

Being released from the hospital, I was sent directly to my first A.A. meeting — September 7, 1943. I came away from the meeting that night with high hope and a strong feeling I had come to the end of my quest, and indeed I had.

Means of Communication

Colliers — Liberty — Saturday Evening Post; they are all gone now, but they were a vital means of communication in those days.

Let's take the newspapers — Chicago, for example. Twenty-seven years ago there were five daily newspapers there. The editor of one and the feature writers on the other four were all A.A. members. I attended my first meeting in Chicago in 1943. Two years later on my way back from attending the 10th Annual Convention in Cleveland, I stopped over again and attended the big Tuesday night meeting. This time it was held not in the Y.W.C.A. with 300 in attendance, but in the Engineers Building with between 3,500 and 4,000 in attendance. Needless to say, the good news of recovery had been told well and often in Chicago between 1943 and 1945.

Of course, for the village drunk to get into A.A., sober up, shape up and again move out into the mainstream of life doesn't have the impact as a "human interest" story it once had. It's more "the expected" than the "unexpected." Just as landing a man on the moon today doesn't have the impact it had just two years ago. As far as I can see "communication without" may be even a little tougher now than it was 25 years ago.

For example, our P.I. Committee has turned up some interesting facts over the past two years, and I would like to scan them briefly: (1) *A.A. as an organization is held in high regard — the paradox.* (2) *54% of those interviewed thought the membership of A.A. was composed of weak, unhappy and neurotic people.* (3) *About one-fourth of the people surveyed said they had never known, or thought they had never known, a member of A.A.* Now if that is the image that people have of the membership of A.A., maybe we had better try to correct it, if we can.

Bill Was Greatest Communicator

Bill was the greatest communicator of them all. He stopped in our town 27 years ago, when we had only 11 members. Two years later I was lucky enough to get a ticket to hear him in Chicago. Bill walked out alone onto the stage and he didn't look too robust. He was very thin, appeared tired, and I think he may have been a little overwhelmed at the spectacle before him — 3,000 wildly cheering people. He started out a little hesitantly, then proceeded to give the greatest talk I have ever heard. As he came to the close of his talk, little frail Edith turned toward me with tears streaming from her eyes and said, "My God, what wonderful use that man has made of his life."

Dr. Bob is gone, Bern is gone, and now Bill is gone. And I'm sure all three of these men at sometime or other were faced with the timeless problem of mortality, "The comfortable retreat or the arduous advance, without the prospect of personal reward."

That is the same problem all of us in A.A. must decide today. I think I know what the decision will be: that this wonderful Fellowship of A.A. "Of the drunk, by the drunk, and for the drunk shall not perish from this earth."

—Don F., Nebraska
Regional Trustee

LOIS SPEAKS TO THE CONFERENCE

Bill had begun to drink just before we were married. He couldn't resist the cocktails offered to young officers at the army post where he was stationed and after one drink always ended up in bed, drunk. As time passed I saw that my whole effort would have to be centered on helping him to overcome his destructive drinking. Bill tried hard to stop during the last few years of his drinking; we went on camping trips, even took a year off from our jobs. Then suddenly, Bill straightened out through the help of an old friend and I considered all our problems solved.

A Wife's Dilemma

When Bill first sobered up, I was extremely happy. Soon, however, without realizing it, I began to resent the fact that he and I never spent any time together any more. My life's job of helping Bill to sober up, with all its responsibilities, was suddenly taken from me. I had not yet found anything to take its place. There was also the feeling of being on the outside of a tight little clique of alcoholics into which no mere wife could enter. I did not understand what was going on within myself until one day Bill asked me to go with him to a meeting. To my surprise as well as his, I burst forth with "Damn your old meeting" and threw a shoe at him.

This bad display of uncalled-for temper woke me up. I realized I had been wallowing in self-pity, that Bill's feverish activity with alcoholics was absolutely necessary to his sobriety and that, if I did not want to be left behind, I had better jump on the bandwagon too.

Later, in the same way, other families of A.A.'s watched the miracle of recovery in their mates. Yearning for a similar change in themselves, they began to apply the Twelve Steps personally. Thus, Al-Anon came into being.

Now Al-Anon has broadened and deepened. Perhaps half its membership are mates of alcoholics not yet in A.A., but we follow your lead. We admit we are powerless over the problem of alcohol in our homes. We take our own inventory and try to keep our hands off your problems. We use the very same precepts that have done so much for you, the Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions. Last year the Al-Anon Conference adopted its Twelve Concepts of Service.

This came none too soon. Al-Anon now has 5,000 groups here, in Canada and in 50 overseas countries. Several of the latter have already established central service offices. The Concepts are a great help in this expansion.

Thus, Al-Anon, as well as A.A., can spread its message indefinitely and yet preserve unity through the use of A.A.'s Three Legacies. This was Bill's dream for our two separate yet fellow societies.

I want to thank you, dear friends, for your many loving remembrances of me at the time of Bill's passing. I'm sorry I haven't been able to write you all personally but at least I have thanked you in my heart. Your kind thought of me has helped to sustain me.

—Lois W.

DIGEST OF AGENDA

Monday, April 19

Registration
Welcome Session and Keynote – Communication
G.S.B. and Policy Committee Reports
Conference Committee Chairman
Opening Dinner: A.A. Meeting with Staff Members

Tuesday, April 20

Publishing – How It Works
A.A.W.S. and Dept. Head Reports
Presentation and Workshop: Cooperation Through Communications
Joint Trustee and Conference Committee Meetings
Voice of the Conference

Wednesday, April 21

Election of Trustees
Board Finance Report and Presentation
A.A. Overseas
Staff Reports
Convention Site Committee Meeting
Presentation and Workshop: Anonymity

Thursday, April 22

Grapevine Presentation
Conference Committee Meetings
Tour of G.S.O. and GV
Delegates Only Dinner and Meeting

Friday, April 23

Conference Committee Reports
Report Back on Workshops
Short Form of Concepts
Demonstration: Conference Report to the Area
Lois, Guest Speaker

Saturday, April 24

Closing Brunch

"AREA HIGHLIGHTS": Each day time was set aside to hear area delegates of Panel 21 report on A.A. in their areas. Excerpts from these are carried on pages 17, 18, and 19.

"ASK-IT-BASKET": Questions submitted anonymously from the floor were discussed and answered at two sessions during the conference. Summaries appear on pages 26 and 27.

VOICE OF THE CONFERENCE: THE DELEGATES SPEAK OUT

1. What Can Young People Contribute to Older Members?

A. The consensus was that young people have "very much" to contribute to older members — "that they bring us new ideas, enthusiasm and hope." One delegate noted that they look to us for example and make us realize what we should be like. "They are looking for all of the things we were looking for when we were young," said another, who pointed out that young people are working hard in the groups and taking over the responsibilities that come their way. "They are the life blood and future of A.A."

2. Is There a Generation Gap in A.A.?

A. Although some delegates pointed out areas of misunderstanding between older and younger members, the majority agreed that there was no real generation gap in A.A., that if we quit talking about it, "it would go away." One delegate said there might be an identity gap when it came to a question of pills and drugs used in conjunction with alcohol, but the general feeling was that "we are all on common ground" — that young people want to be part of A.A. and not isolated — that they don't think the program should be changed for them — that they, like other members, came to A.A. because they hurt and their lives were unmanageable. One delegate quoted a young member as telling him: "We need each other and help each other and should avoid stereotypes of each other."

3. The Responsibility of Sponsorship — Is Sponsorship Declining?

A. There was general agreement that sponsorship is changing, if not declining. For the most part, the questions and answers centered around the point of carrying the message to the newcomer. It was felt that the changes had come about for many reasons, and the question was, what to do about it. One delegate pointed out that through an increase in education, the availability of treatment centers and other facilities, many alcoholics were coming into A.A. sober and didn't need the kind of 12th Stepping they did in the old days. Another noted that sponsors today don't seem to have time, that we are always in a hurry, and send newcomers to hospitals in order to get rid of them. "We're short-changing ourselves if we don't practice old-style sponsorship," said another, who noted that sponsorship is a sharing you don't find on any other level. There should be more discussion in groups on how both the older member and the newcomer benefit from sponsorship delegates said, agreeing with one who pointed out that if sponsorship is declining, "it is up to us to go back to our areas and do something about it."

4. What Can Be Done in Areas That Are Becoming Slums When Groups Are Moving Out and Not Being Replaced?

A. While some delegates spoke of once solid groups closing down or being reduced to one or two members because of changes in neighborhoods, others noted that this didn't have to be the case. Some reported that suburban

groups in their areas were bringing meetings into deteriorating neighborhoods and now there was "standing room only." Others helped maintain groups on a rotating basis or simply moved people to other groups in other neighborhoods, while one delegate voiced the opinion that this shouldn't be a problem with a solid group, no matter how the neighborhood changed.

5. Closed and Open Meetings.

A. When polled on the ratio of open and closed meetings in their areas, 53 delegates said there were more open meetings, while 26 said more were closed — that is, not open to non-members. One delegate said that the open meetings were a problem because some outsiders made a practice of attending regularly and were a "pain in the neck." Another said that meetings have to be closed in smaller areas so that they can bring in newcomers and that they try to encourage Al-Anon to meet on the same night so wives don't feel left out. One delegate noted that the problem had been solved in his area when the central office began to set up open-to-the-public meetings at regular intervals in different areas of the city.

6. Should G.S.O. and A.A. Service Offices Accept Contributions From "Clubs" Formed by A.A.'s for A.A.'s? Should A.A. Groups Contribute to Clubs?

A. There was no final answer on this question, although delegates voiced strong opinions on the matter. Many A.A. groups do not use the word "group" but call themselves a "club." In this situation, a delegate said it was up to the group to make the distinction clear. A club charges dues: a group does not. Groups that meet in clubs sometimes give their G.S.O. contributions to the secretary of the club and these contributions are mailed in on club stationery. Groups do meet in clubs, but it was suggested they can keep all their business affairs separate from the club, including their treasury. The majority of delegates felt that clubs should not solicit funds from groups, nor should groups contribute to clubs. (Since no conclusion was reached, this question will be an item on the 1972 Conference agenda.)

REGULAR A.A. MEETING FOLLOWS OPEN DINNER

The opening dinner of the 1971 Conference was followed by a regular A.A. meeting, at which each of the G.S.O. and Grapevine staff members told of how they had found A.A.

Terry P., delegate from Manitoba, who chaired the meeting, shared his experience in working the Twelve Steps of the A.A. program.

Alcoholic Counseling Program

The Economic Opportunity Act of 1964 as amended December 31, 1969, established a new national emphasis program entitled "Alcoholic Counseling and Recovery Program." The purpose of this program as defined in the enabling legislation, is "to discover and treat the disease of alcoholism. . . to be community based, serve the objective of the maintenance of the family structure as well as the recovery of the individual alcoholic, encourage the use of neighborhood facilities and the services of recovered alcoholics as counselors, and emphasize the re-entry of the alcoholic into society." Last year this program was funded in the amount of \$9,000,000 — 1972 OEO budget requests include 13 million dollars for this program.

Multi-Service Centers operated by the Community Action Agencies and Neighborhood Health Centers are key points of contact for the low-income alcoholic and his family. Important in this effort is the development of greater community acceptance of the alcoholic and his family. Local programs focus on identifying alcoholics and problem drinkers from among those persons currently eligible to receive services from the Community Action Agency or the Neighborhood Health Center.

—Hal M., Delegate

No Monopoly on Recovery

One of the comments made by Bill was: "Let us be ever mindful that Alcoholics Anonymous does not have the monopoly in the business of alcoholism." He also said that while the Steps and Traditions had stood the test of time, the application of our service techniques may have to be changed over the years. Bill paid tribute on many occasions to those he called our non-alcoholic friends and wrote a never-to-be-forgotten article entitled, "Let's Be Friendly with Our Friends." If it had not been for our friends in the early days, A.A. would not be what it is today.

If we know, understand and practice our Traditions we have nothing to fear. Communication is a two-way street and we should take a good look at what other agencies are doing, and let them know what we have to offer.

—John R., trustee

No Reason for Conflict

A.A. clearly defines itself as a non-professional, self-selected group therapy available to anyone who wishes to use it to assist in recovering from the disease of alcoholism. The professional organization, on the other hand, is concerned with the disease

COMMUNICATION OUTSIDE A.A. —

of alcoholism, on the basis that if certain manifestations are present, the individual is suffering from alcoholism regardless as to whether or not he admits this condition.

To the extent that an intergroup office follows the dictates of the A.A. program, and the professional information and referral center operates from the disease concept with proper referral including A.A., there is little reason for conflict or confusion. It is when these issues are cloudy, or when either the A.A. intergroup secretary or the professional usurp the other's responsibility that difficulties develop.

—Bill P., Prof. Rel. Comm.

Alcoholism — Management Problem

A major breakthrough in the Labor-Management area occurred last November; a 1½ day session on "Alcoholism as a Management Problem," sponsored by the American Management Association. Sixty-five representatives of government and giants of industry listened to experts in the field of alcoholism describe industrial programs of rehabilitation for alcoholics now in operation because management recognized and accepted the fact that positive rehabilitation programs were not only needed but, in every instance, profitable ventures. In each instance, participants stated that A.A. was the most successful referral resource — one that was always available without having to go through a maze of red tape. In most cases, an A.A. member played a major role in the implementation of planned and programmed rehabilitation.

An officer from the national headquarters of the AFL-CIO participated in the program and reiterated the union's recognition of the need for rehabilitation programs in industry and government, and their complete willingness to cooperate fully

—Jim H., trustee-at-large

Church Actively Concerned With Alcohol Problems

We of A.A. should be aware of the great interest and fruitful activity of the church in the field of alcoholism. While there is much to be done, and much has been left undone, we should look hopefully at what has been accomplished up to now.

One of the most successful organizations is the North Conway Institute which was founded in 1951 as an outgrowth of interfaith, interdenominational, ecumenical seminars, panels, and other meetings. The Institute has two basic functions. On the one hand, it is a professional (and private, non-profit) consultancy to church bodies and religious organizations; on the

BEING FRIENDLY WITH OUR FRIENDS

other hand, it is an informal, person-to-person association, or fellowship, for religiously oriented alcoholism authorities.

Its annual conference, held each June in North Conway, N.H., is attended by Protestants, Roman Catholics, and Jews. Delegates first came together, and have ever since, to plan ecumenical action on national, regional, and local problems regarding the use, non-use, and abuse of beverage alcohol. While delegates may hold varying theological positions on the moderate use of alcohol and on the practice of abstinence, they agree on the necessity to work for the reduction and, if possible, elimination of problem drinking. The great strength of North Conway Institute has been derived essentially from the fact that it is a dynamic, emergent consensus movement. Its executive director is a recovered alcoholic who is also an Episcopal clergyman.

—Eric B., trustee

Professional Relations Committee Seeks Improved Communications

Our beloved Bill used to say that A.A. had the capacity to carry the message to 100,000 new alcoholics a year, but the alcoholic had to be able to find us or be led to us. The explosion of interest in the alcoholic on the part of professional groups and individuals just might be the source for unprecedented numbers of new Twelve Step cases each year. With the realization that alcoholism has become a prime concern and target from the top levels of government right down the ladder to the local committee, doctor, clergyman, hospital, etc., the Professional Relations Committee has undertaken to learn something about the various programs and activities of several different categories of groups concerned with the sick alcoholic.

One thing we learned, almost without exception, is that A.A. is considered by professionals to be the number one resource for alcoholics who want help. A.A. is available almost everywhere, almost all the time, and what's more, it's free. We also learned that when open communication exists between A.A. members and the paid alcoholism worker, the professionals give A.A. credit, and the A.A.'s return the compliment, and the sick alcoholic is the winner.

We're not competitive with these non-A.A.'s and vice versa; we have our separate functions. A.A. is not in the business of education, research, counseling, treatment, prevention or funding — we simply have a message to carry about a program of recovery for alcoholics — a program that works for most of those who want it. The "pro" can help the alcoholic want it by education, counseling, knowledge through research, rehabilitative treatment, and through making the community become aware of and care about the millions who still suffer from the killing disease which, through the grace of God, A.A. has helped us arrest.

—Cora Louise B., G.S.O.

(cont'd. on p. 25)

Delegates Share Experience

In a workshop, Cooperation Through Communication, delegates were asked to share their experience so that the Fellowship can be guided toward better understanding, cooperation and communication with outside agencies.

Most delegates indicated that there is good communication between A.A. and state and provincial alcoholism agencies, many of which have had programs for a long time. At the same time, attempts are being made to establish good communications with the newer ones. Delegates felt that the best communications were maintained with prisons, courts, churches and state hospitals. Some of the methods of cooperation were in picking up patients and taking them to meetings, while in another state patrolmen distribute A.A. literature to alcoholics and refer them to A.A.

Many Problems With Agencies

Problems which result in association with these agencies and programs are also fairly numerous. Some examples: A.A. members who set themselves up as professional counselors without any training. A.A. members who, when working for other agencies, are confused as to their position and break their anonymity. In one state, a law prohibits state agencies from referring alcoholics to non-cooperating agencies, and A.A. is not listed as a cooperating agency. Older members sometimes reject these agencies, feeling that A.A. is the only answer to alcoholism. Confusion arises in regard to agencies in which alcoholism and drug addiction come under the same program. It was felt that many of these problems can be resolved through local institutions committees.

Good Relations With Council / Information Centers

Delegates indicated that there were even better relations with alcoholism councils and information centers, although there were exceptions. This was primarily because these agencies were older and better established and because many A.A.'s serve them in an individual capacity. It was found that there has been little chance to evaluate the cooperation between A.A. and the projects sponsored by the Office of Economic Opportunity, although it has resulted in some problems, where there is a confusion between A.A. and O.E.O. detox centers, half-way houses and counseling. Another problem cited was that some A.A.'s may be exploiting these programs since much money is available and some individuals see an opportunity to use them to their own advantage which results in a bad image for A.A. Communications are improving, however, and the problems are working themselves out. It was generally felt that we in A.A. need to be better educated as individuals and as a Fellowship in order to better cooperate and communicate with other agencies.

—Luke B., S.W. Ohio/N. Ky.
Workshop Reporter

As the Public Sees A.A.

More than half of the general public pictures A.A. members as being weak, unhappy, neurotic . . . so we learned from three recent samplings of public opinion all across the country by your P.I. Committee, as authorized by A.A.'s General Service Board.

Surveys Undertaken

First, in 1968, a study was conducted covering A.A. members attending 5% of all the A.A. meetings in each state of the U.S. and each province of Canada. That study revealed that 55% of the 13,000 respondents came into A.A. through an A.A. member. This is more than came in through all other sources combined.

Second, a survey was made of the opinions held by the general public about A.A. and A.A. members. Only about 1/4 of the people surveyed said that they knew a member of A.A. The other 3/4 may actually not have known anyone in A.A., or they may have been unaware of the A.A. membership of someone they did know.

At any rate, the people who said they did not know anyone in A.A. harbored a pretty unattractive conception of us A.A. members; 58% of them think of us as "weak," 58% as "unhappy," 54% "neurotic" and 50% "sensitive."

How many people do you think would voluntarily seek help of an individual who filled that description?

Finally, the study among the public revealed that people who do know a member of A.A. think far better of us.

If we put all these findings together, we must draw several concrete conclusions:

1. A.A. members are by far the most important bridgehead to A.A.
2. Most people do not know any A.A. member, or if they do, are unaware of it.
3. Our "image" among those who know us is such that they might be willing to seek our help. But our "image" among the great majority who do not know us is positively repellent.

Let's speculate for a moment about why there exists this unattractive misconception about A.A. members.

Probably for two reasons. First, in our drinking days, we had a fairly high degree of visibility. We were seen, heard and talked about in varying degrees of inebriation. Then we quit drinking and came into A.A. (or vice versa). We immediately became invisible.

The second reason surely has to do with the Anonymity Tradition. Sober A.A. members are never seen in any public medi-

THE QUESTION OF ANONYMITY:

um — only drunks. This would be a minor handicap to establishing our character if we were known on a private level. But many of us are not. This personal invisibility seems to stem from a misconception about the Anonymity Tradition. Vast numbers of A.A. members seem to think that they are prohibited from telling friends, associates and acquaintances about their A.A. membership. The prohibition in the Anonymity Tradition applies to public print, broadcast and film. It does not apply to our personal dealings.

If the principal channel to A.A. is A.A. members, and if alcoholics are being condemned to continue suffering because we members have never made ourselves known, it would seem that each of us has an obligation to shed our reticence wherever we can and each to become his own private information committee with family, friends, doctors, lawyers, minister, business associates.

Public information is restricted by tradition. But private information is here for the giving and far more effective.

And what are the rewards of telling people about our membership in A.A.? First, it provides us one more safeguard against the possibility of reaching for a drink. Second, it grants us freedom from furtiveness. We were furtive about our drinking. How exhilarating to be open about our sobriety! And, finally, shedding our reticence is almost like a miracle in the new opportunities it creates for us to help others achieve sobriety!

And after all, isn't this what we are all about?

— Bayard P., chairman, P.I.C.

Bill's Anonymity

I would like to focus on just two aspects of anonymity at the public level which have recently brought forth a spate of letters to the General Service Office. The first of these deals with why Bill's anonymity was broken after his death. It was neither an accident nor a hasty decision.

It was the subject of a great deal of thought and discussion on the part of your Board of Trustees quite a few years ago. The Board's final decision to use Bill's name and picture in the obituary stories was made primarily because of one fact: based on the best available information from friends in the various communications media, both members and non-members alike, the Board simply had to accept the fact that, in the opinion of all these experts, Bill's anonymity simply *could not* be kept. In this sense, then, the decision was, in effect, a bowing to the inevitable. By sanctioning the use of Bill's name and picture, the Board not only made "honest men" out of the press and broadcast corps, but at the same time avoided recriminations, letters of protest and all other manifestations of displeasure which could have caused substantial alienation of the press.

Finally, the 1960 General Service Conference itself did not disagree with this conclusion of the Board of Trustees, as it listened to and approved the recommendation pertaining to

SOME POINTS OF VIEW

this question: "It was recommended that the Board adopt the following policy statement to be used in answering inquiries relating to the posthumous breaking of anonymity: 'The Board believes that A.A. members generally think it unwise to break the anonymity of a member even after his death, but that in each situation, the final decision must rest with the family.'"

The second question concerning anonymity which has resulted in quite a few letters to our office has to do with disclosure of membership in the case of a few very well-known A.A.'s, whether or not the original break of anonymity came from the individual concerned. Most of the anonymity breaks regarding our better known members are now made by others; almost without exception these few individuals *do not* publicly proclaim themselves as members. But since the fact of their membership is known, for whatever reason, they cannot prevent these occasional breaks in anonymity. Thus it would seem that it is scarcely fair to blame them for anonymity breaks which they are powerless to control. If a reporter says that "Secretary so-and-so" or "Commissioner what's-his-name" is a member of A.A., there is really nothing that the secretary or the commissioner can do to prevent it. —Bob H.

Too Anonymous Inside the Fellowship?

Anonymity Within A.A. may seem a strange subject for us to be discussing today because there seems to be nothing written in our Twelve Traditions which suggests that we be anonymous within A.A.

And yet, in some areas and countries around the world, A.A. members are as anonymous within their group as they are at the level of press, radio and films. I do not say this critically, it is just a fact. And, I wonder why? Is this their interpretation of the Traditions based on anonymity? Do they feel prestige, pride and personality are involved in using full names within A.A.? How do you feel about it? We ask because we truly want your thinking on this subject.

In our particular culture, one's name seems to be the first tool of communication. And, because so many first names are similar, we really need full names to identify each other. I caused myself some difficulty when I first contacted A.A. by giving the Intergroup Office my maiden rather than my married name. It was only through diligent efforts of an A.A. gal in my local group that a letter from her reached me two months later. She gave me her full name, address and phone number. Why didn't I give my correct name? I was afraid; I was not sure I wanted to join A.A., I was confused and frightened. I am glad my sponsor was not. She gave freely.

We also encounter certain problems at G.S.O. because of a misunderstanding of anonymity within A.A. Some of them are:

1. Letters arrive with only first names and last initial. It makes them difficult to answer.

2. Minutes of area assemblies arrive with only first names and last initials. It makes the participation on the part of G.S.O. in the meeting, from the minutes, rather difficult.
3. Committee member lists arrive with only first names and last initials. This limited information makes it impossible to place them on the G.S.O. mailing list. (*cont'd. p. 19*)

Anonymity Within A.A.

There were nine workshops held on Wednesday evening on the subject of "Anonymity Within A.A."

The consensus on each of the following questions was:

What is the experience in your area regarding the use of full names at:

1. Closed meetings?

More than 50% reported use of full names at closed meetings.

2. Speaking at open meetings?

About 2/3 of those reporting indicated that full names are *not* used at open meetings.

3. In assemblies?

About 50% use full names.

4. Written reports and minutes of business meetings?

About 50% use full names and addresses in written reports and minutes.

5. Lists of area committee officers, committee members and G.S.R.'s?

All but two use full names and addresses.

6. Correspondence within A.A.?

All but two use full names and addresses.

In answer to the sense of the meeting, all felt that the use of full names within A.A. at both open and closed meetings and assemblies could improve communication and, thus, be an aid to A.A. growth. They also felt that the use of full names and addresses in minutes, written reports and correspondence within A.A. would improve communication.

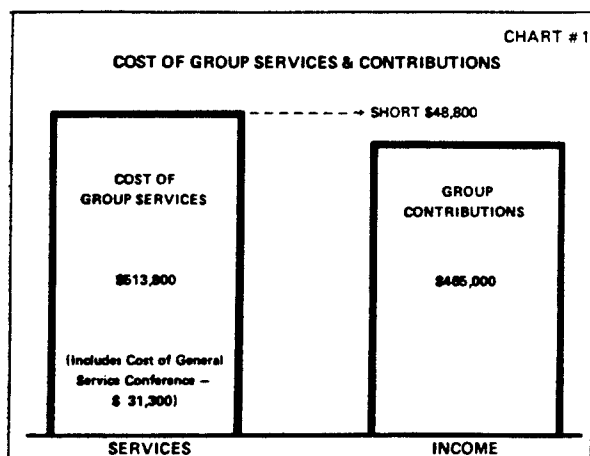
All workshops seem to favor this Conference making such a recommendation, but also keeping in mind that it always remains the choice of the individual member. It was felt that an explanation of A.A.'s Anonymity Tradition would be helpful if explained in sponsoring and in group discussions. These discussions might discourage the trend toward anonymity within A.A. which seems to exist today. This opening of the line of communication could enhance A.A. growth — which is the theme of our Conference.

—Doris C., S.W. Texas
Workshop Reporter

MONEY AT G.S.O. — WHERE IT

When it comes to classing G.S.O. as a business, it would have to be classed as a small business. However, unlike any other small business, in terms of shareholders we have over 16,000 groups. These groups are interested in knowing where the money comes from and where it goes. Literally tens of thousands of A.A. members would like to know all about A.A.'s finances. And, because money has always been a troublesome subject in the past, they have every right to know.

G.S.O. plots its fiscal course on an annual basis. Basically, the financial structure is simple. It looks complicated, however, when you try to show it in detail on an income statement, balance sheet, or budget. I believe these simple charts will help.



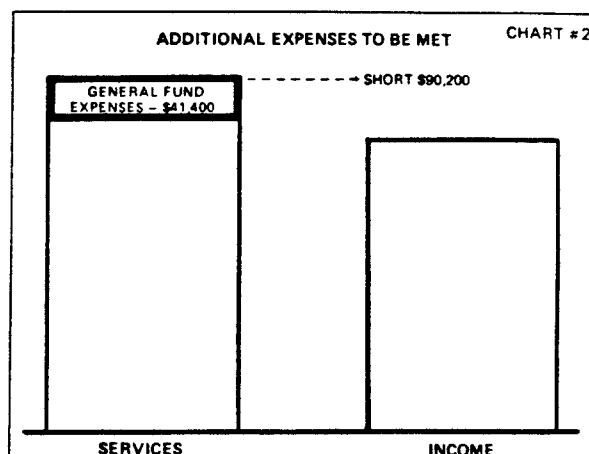
In planning the 1971 budget, the Trustees' Finance Committee managed to effect economies in many areas without reducing group services. However, growth of the Fellowship and the constantly increasing cost of doing business adds to service costs year after year.

Anticipated group contributions fall \$48,800 below the cost of group services. Through the years, the cost of group services has rarely been met by contributions.

Each of these charts shows service costs on the left; income on the right. Chart #1 shows the cost of group services as provided for in the 1971 budget — \$513,800. At the right, we see the anticipated group contributions at \$465,000. This is \$48,800 below the budgeted cost of group services. Group services should be matched by contributions, but this hasn't happened for years.

Chart #2 illustrates that there are other G.S.O. expenses to be met: General Fund expenses of \$41,400, representing the cost of holding trustees' meetings; the Public Information and Professional Relations Committees' expenses; the cost of producing a filmstrip, plus other special projects. At this point, we see that we are falling short of reality by \$90,200. So, now we must rely on the publishing operation for assistance. Our book and pamphlet business, after paying its own share of operating expenses, has \$79,700 left over to contribute to the pot. Chart #3 shows how this cuts the anticipated deficit to \$10,500.

Chart #4 lets us see how that \$10,500 deficit will be met in 1971 — by using accumulated investment income from the

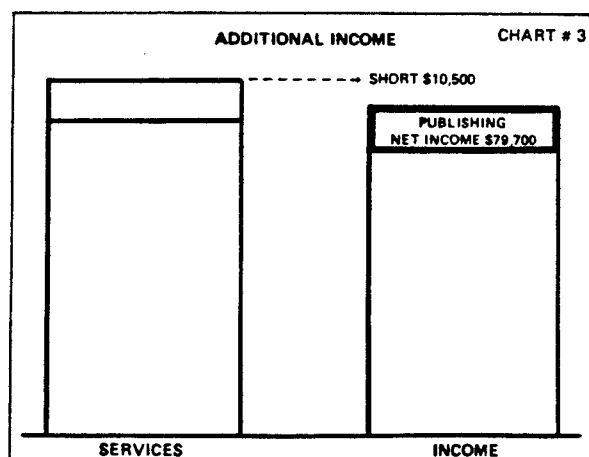


In addition to the cost of group services, there are other G.S.O. expenses to be met. General Fund expenses, totaling \$41,400, represent the cost of Board meetings, Public Information and Professional Relations Committee expenses, film strip expenses and other special projects. The combined cost of General Fund and Group Service expenses now exceed income by \$90,200.

Reserve Fund with a possible contribution from the A.A. Grapevine operation.

So for 1971 it is possible to work within anticipated income without cutting A.A. services, and without digging into Reserve principal. This is not strictly a balanced budget, but it is a practical one. Of course we must continually strive for increased income and to keep service expenses from going through the roof . . . we are doing just that. For instance, on the income side . . .

All evidence indicates that the Regular Contribution Plan, if we continue to give it the help it needs, will bring group contributions up to a point closer to carrying the cost of group services. Through this plan we have contact with all groups via the quarterly mailings of contribution statements. Because of this they are encouraged to correspond more frequently and



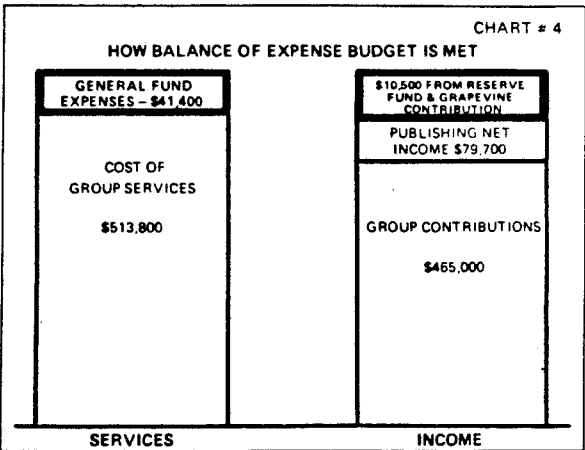
After paying its own share of operating expenses, the Publishing activity anticipates a net income for the year in the amount of \$79,700. This total amount will be contributed toward expenses, reducing the expected deficit to \$10,500.

COMES FROM—HOW IT IS SPENT

take advantage of the services available. Knowing that G.S.O. means worldwide service, more and more groups will realize that these services deserve the support of every group. Also, through a regular program of planned production economies, we have kept the printing costs of our literature and directories from rising, even though printing costs in general have risen sharply. Thus we have kept the publishing gross profit from skidding into a downward trend.

On the other side of the ledger, we are constantly doing what we can — and asking your cooperation — to cut basic costs so that inflation and the cost of more services to more groups will still leave us with a workable budget. For example, while the Conference has increased in size and in total activities, the Conference budget has actually decreased 4% over the past five years. It has taken your full cooperation to bring this about and still keep the kind of Conference the movement needs on the kind of budget we can afford. We are doing all that we can, in big and little ways, to keep costs in line, to buy wisely, to ask constantly, "Is this expense good for the movement? Will it help the alcoholic?"

G.S.O. finances are the concern of every group and member. It is the responsibility of all of us at G.S.O. to get as much mileage as possible out of each A.A. dollar and it is up to all



A possible contribution from the A.A. Grapevine, Inc. and income from the Reserve Fund will be used to offset the remaining deficit which was budgeted at \$10,500.

of us to tell the groups and A.A.'s everywhere that G.S.O. means worldwide service and deserves the support of every group and member.

Dennis Manders, controller

PRINTING AND REPRINT PERMISSION

The General Service Office here in New York is the energy center of communications for members and groups throughout the world. A.A. World Services, Inc. is responsible for the administrative management of the New York office. Among the duties and responsibilities of A.A.W.S. is the publishing and distribution of the books and literature of Alcoholics Anonymous and many other special pamphlets.

When a new pamphlet is proposed, or an old one is revised and updated, it is thoroughly reviewed by your Conference Committee on Literature and the Trustees' Literature Committee. After final editing and approval by both committees, it is turned over to A.A. World Services for publication. Usually when a new pamphlet is available, a special notice or flyer, such as many of you received with the publication of "A Member's-Eye View," will be mailed. The order blank is revised and updated from time to time, adding new items available.

When you see the actual figures of the numbers of books and pamphlets sold, and you realize the cash contributions which the publishing function makes to the operation of the General Service activity, you will consider it worthwhile. The publishing and distribution of the books and pamphlets is certainly a responsibility to make sure that the tools you and I found . . . (the books and pamphlets, to help us maintain sobriety and life itself) are always available for the still sick alcoholic who stumbles in the darkness, looking for help.

*—Bob M., director
A.A. World Services, Inc.*

Since all of our books and pamphlets are copyrighted, permission must be obtained for any reprint.

Each request for permission to reprint A.A. literature receives a careful review by experienced staff members and then by the directors of A.A.W.S.

Since our publications are readily available in the U.S., A.A. World Services does not normally grant permission to reprint material in full. Consequently, this permission is usually given for excerpts from books and pamphlets, most of which are requested by institutions, individuals or organizations interested in the field of alcoholism.

We encourage A.A. in foreign countries to reprint any or all of our material including the Big Book, whenever the membership justifies such an operation. These often involve translations which we check for accuracy.

During 1970, we granted permission for several interesting uses of A.A. material. For example, we authorized recordings of the Big Book for the blind, translation and reproduction of "This is A.A." in Swedish and Eastern Arctic Eskimo and granted the American Group in Seoul, Korea, permission to reprint Chapter 5 of the Big Book.

We try very hard not to deny reprint permission to responsible people and extend fullest cooperation to anyone, anywhere, who wishes to help carry the A.A. message.

*—Walter M., director
A.A. World Services, Inc.*

GRAPEVINE HEALTHY AND GROWING

The Grapevine is healthy and growing. Judging by our mail and what people tell us, the Grapevine is read with great interest and enthusiasm by more members of our Fellowship than ever before. Paula and I share one philosophy about the Grapevine: we want it to reflect the current thinking of A.A. members. We try to be responsive to the questions and concerns and ideas of our members. We try to tell it like it is in A.A., from one twenty-four hours to another. We believe the present enthusiasm for the GV stems from a feeling on the part of our Fellowship that the magazine is truly their magazine.

When our material for an issue has been selected, edited and set into galleys, I lay out the magazine, attaching blurbs and art work, and hope that it comes out looking like a mature and well-designed magazine.

Alcoholics are often said to be perfectionists and in one area we try to be. We feel that as working drunks we made enough mistakes and our hope is that a magazine by and for sober drunks will be as free from mistakes as possible.

I want to make a plea to all of you; that is, begin to think about the Grapevine as one of our major tools for achieving and maintaining sobriety. Along with the 12th Step call, telephone therapy, the Big Book and special pamphlets, remember the Grapevine. It is as current as the next speaker at an open meeting, it poses more questions and suggests more answers than you will find in your next discussion meeting, it is a meeting in print for the sick alcoholic in a hospital bed, or for a Loner aboard a ship in the mid-Atlantic. It is as mature as the oldest oldtimer, yet as basic in A.A. philosophy as anything you could tell the newest newcomer and because it is reborn every month, it is the newest and best reflection of A.A. life as it is today, right now, that we have. Yes, we want a bigger circulation and we want more subscriptions, but most of all we want more people reading, using and talking about the Grapevine. My fondest wish is that you go home with the idea that the Grapevine can help and that you talk about it with the folks back home and get them talking about it. —Jack M., editor

Communication

Natural for Grapevine

Our Conference theme on Communication is a natural one for the Grapevine. Of course it is a large portion of the concern and responsibility of all A.A.'s to communicate. But it is the primary purpose of the magazine to initiate the sharing of experience, strength and hope of A.A.'s with each other through communication.

A part of my job that I love most is working with the writers. About 85% of the content of any issue comes through the mail, unsolicited. The remainder may come from the Editorial Board members, or by assignment to writers we know from past Grapevine contributions. Bill W. contributed to the Grapevine, writing close to 75 articles over the years, and some of

GRAPEVINE CIRCULATION

	<u>4/71</u>	<u>4/70</u>
United States	51,378	47,382
Canada	7,016	6,661
U. S. Possessions	133	120
All Foreign	935	906

Increase for the period: 4,393

his vital A.A. thinking was expressed through the magazine. For instance, do you know that Bill first serialized our Traditions in the Grapevine? Do you know that he wrote on Responsibility, Leadership and such thoughtful pieces of importance to us all, as Fear, Love and Honesty? When a piece came to us that had excellent literary merit, but somehow gave us an uneasy feeling, I'd take it to Bill. He's read it and after a few paragraphs, he'd say, "Here's what's bothering you. You're right, and I'll tell you why." He would always spot the problem and could point up the error in thinking, usually by an example from his own experience. He taught us well, and now, when we ask, "What would Bill say about this?" the answer is there.

Quite often a piece in the Grapevine will start a response from readers that results in a number of articles on one theme. One such that provoked a spiritual series was an article from an agnostic with a covering letter that really took us apart. Our agnostic friend ended his letter by assuring us that we wouldn't dare publish his piece and furthermore he really didn't want to see it in such a magazine. The dare left us unmoved, but the article was good. We wrote him, we published and we are now good friends, and he's still an agnostic.

I handle all mail and I *do* feel a responsibility for the correspondence we receive. We believe, above all, that the Grapevine is rendering a service to the Fellowship. Often the correspondence is simply one A.A. talking to another on individual problems, or working the program. I try to answer all these with tender, loving care. I also have the chore of rejecting material we can't use. Among these are tributes, personal prayers and poetry. Now, about poetry — please don't misunderstand — we like the stuff very much. A.A.'s are serious about their program, but they are *very* serious about their poetry. Our space is quite simply too limited and if we accept some and rejected others, resentments would flare, subscriptions lapse and we could never weather it.

Unquestionably the work is demanding and each day we may be hit by a deadline or a printing, mail or production crisis, but this we try to take in stride, for we are even more aware that the Grapevine is a current and living tool of A.A.'s everywhere who are seeking maturity in their sobriety today, now.

—Paula C., managing editor

Area Highlights

ALABAMA – NORTHWEST FLORIDA – In addition to the annual Conference our area holds two area assemblies for G.S.R.'s and district committeemen. Their effectiveness is shown through the recent creation of a strong Institutional Committee following a panel discussion on this subject. We also started the Big Brother Plan, patterned after those in Ohio and Louisiana.
—Jack C.

ARKANSAS – We have a very active alcoholic commission which is responsible for an effective rehabilitation program. There is an alcoholic ward at the state hospital to which an alcoholic can go, either by choice or court order. It is supervised by doctors and psychiatrists who suggest A.A. to the patient. The ward is sponsored by one of the Little Rock groups so that the patient is in constant touch with A.A.
—C.W.G.

BRITISH COLUMBIA/YUKON – Our area is 570,000 square miles and communication is difficult. In order to gain greater participation we have moved our assembly from Vancouver to Penticton in the south central part of our area. We have also established traveling committeemen meetings which will be held quarterly in different parts of our area. We have many younger members coming in and our public information is good.—Bill V.

CALIFORNIA (Northern Coastal) – It is obvious to me that A.A. activity is largely communications, whether talking to a newcomer or carrying the message worldwide. The only problem in our area is getting G.S.R.'s and district committeemen to serve, but this is not unusual. A recent public information meeting held in San Francisco did a great deal to stimulate the area General Service Committee.
—Jim A.

CALIFORNIA (Southern) – Our area is hosting the Pacific A.A. service assembly this year. This will help us establish communications between the states within the region. Our bi-monthly area assemblies are held at various locations which serve to stimulate interest in area activities. We are setting up an area events calendar to prevent scheduling conflicts of major events.
—Carl B.

COLORADO – The group conscience and unity in our state is very good, as is group participation and communication at the state level. We have a quarterly newsletter which publishes stories about what is happening throughout the state. In addition to area round-robins, we have four regional meetings a year, as well as a state convention, all of which are aimed at improved communication.
—John N.

CONNECTICUT – One of the most important activities in our area relative to communication is in the printing and distribution of meeting schedules. It has proved to be a very effective way of getting our groups together, involving the activities of committeemen and G.S.R.'s. Schedules are printed and distributed at no cost to the groups.
—Bill R.

DISTRICT OF COLUMBIA – During the past year we have started a "Deaf Group." A member with normal hearing learned sign language and acts as interpreter. Professional interpreters who are non-members have also helped. The group is going well. At a recent meeting there were nine deaf members in attendance. Among other things, we are striving to improve our reporting of membership figures from our area.
—Hal M.

FLORIDA (North) – We recently established an Institutional Committee made up of G.S.R.'s from various localities to arrange for sponsorship and meetings for all existing institutional groups. Where the need is found, new groups are formed. We have also established a Public Information Committee which is made up of G.S.R.'s from representative areas.
—Sam I.

FLORIDA (South) – Members of A.A. throughout the entire state grew closer as they prepared for and hosted the 1970 International Convention. All members and groups stepped forward in a unified effort to be part of this event. South Florida has 185 groups and 3,000 members and our "time and place" cards are incorrect almost as soon as printed due to the addition of new groups.
—Patricia G.

HAWAII – We feel that we are lucky because we get so many A.A. visitors from everywhere and think this continual exposure has a favorable effect on our membership. Our growth is not as rapid as we think it should be, and we are looking for ways to solve our problem of communicating with outsiders and reaching the public more effectively.
—Bob A.

ILLINOIS (Chicago) – Our structured organization was set up to obtain a large amount of active participation from the top to the bottom. The various committees report to the Metropolitan Rotating Committee. At all levels it is the membership which decides which subjects and matters of importance should be referred to the chairman. We are still working hard to obtain more participation from A.A. members at the local level.
—Joe C.

ILLINOIS (Southern) – Unity in our area is growing. More areas are having monthly meetings and we have started quarterly meetings and workshops in our Southern Illinois areas. As a result groups are better informed, unity has more importance to us all, and communication among groups is being improved.
—Adam H.

INDIANA (Northern) – We extend an open invitation to group G.S.R.'s to hold workshops so they may better understand their operations and functions in this position. We also have a newsletter which relates state area highlights and activities of the state committee. We have an annual state conference which usually makes money enough so that we can make an additional contribution to G.S.O.
—Richard H.

IOWA – We have had a pilot program financed by the federal and state government in which the University of Iowa has set up a treatment unit for alcoholics so that young interns and doctors can take an active part in the field of alcoholism. It has an A.A. orientation and A.A. groups put meetings on at the university.
—Hank B.

LOUISIANA – Communications are improving in our area, there are more intergroup committees and more area assembly meetings. We are also concentrating on keeping people active, stressing that both oldtimers and newcomers can be useful. Being "a part of" seems to be very important to us all, and we feel everyone has something to offer.
—Gloria C.

MASSACHUSETTS (Eastern) – We are currently trying to improve communications through an area redistricting project which gives a chairman authority to appoint temporary committeemen in districts where there is little representation. Once

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established, these districts can then elect their own committees. Our second effort involves creation of a Public Information Committee.

—Stuart N.

MICHIGAN (Central) — Each year we hold an area-wide, three-day conference which features discussion panels on various subjects. We also hold committee and G.S.R. meetings once a month. We have supplied all State Police posts with A.A. literature to be given in any incidents when they feel alcohol may be a problem. We also have a prison parolee sponsorship program.

—George McM.

MICHIGAN (Southeastern) — We have one public meeting a year which is a key to A.A. growth and communication. We do our best to cover all institutions and we have a very active P.I.C. which provides radio, television and newspapers with public announcements of A.A. activities in our area. Our G.S.R. panels travel extensively to talk on the three legacies — Recover, Unity, Service.

—Ken C.

MINNESOTA (Southern) — In the next two years we hope to give our members a more extensive knowledge of the total operations of general services through better communications directly to each member in each group, opening a better channel for exchange of ideas within our area. This will mean more activity among group members.

—Warren McG.

MISSOURI (Eastern) — Although most groups are in St. Louis, the rest of our area is expanding rapidly. This is attributable to the use of volunteer A.A. members as referrals from the state hospitals and workshops held to stimulate interest and encouragement of new members. We hold business meetings in different locations to stimulate interest in G.S.O. and world services as well as to bridge local communications problems.

—Don B.

MISSOURI (Western) — We have detoxification centers in five western area hospitals, all of which hold two A.A. meetings a week. A new intergroup has opened which has been very helpful in referring new people to A.A. groups in their own community, as well as in helping to get speakers for outside meetings in churches, schools and hospitals.

—Gus W.

NEVADA — Communication between our northern and southern cities is excellent, but we lack contact with groups in sparsely populated areas. We distribute literature to nonalcoholic professionals in these areas, and they in turn help us contact sick alcoholics who might want A.A. We make contact by mail or phone and send them taped meetings on cassettes which are inexpensive and can be used again and again.

—Dick T.

NEW JERSEY (Northern) — One of the things that we think might help us encourage more activity is to start a tapelibrary. Last year we placed meeting lists in all police stations and state police barracks. We need to rebuild interest in our area by going directly to the groups to overcome an apathy that seems to exist, not only among G.S.R.'s but among intergroup delegates.

—Bill B.

NEW YORK (Central) — In Rochester we have a specialized group restricted to parolees or former inmates of a state or federal prison. They have one open meeting a month to which all are invited. In seven years only two members have been re-

committed because of crimes, and there are now similar meetings in other areas. The State Parole Board informs us that three such groups will be formed in New York City this year.

—Jack B.

NEW YORK (Southeastern) — The key to growth in our area is activity and without communication, activity is impossible. Toward this end our monthly newsletter goes to all groups. Our Public Information Study Committee and Institutional Study Committee have sent out questionnaires to discover what each group is doing in these all-important areas.

—John R.

NORTH CAROLINA — We have four area committee meetings a year, usually with 100 percent attendance of committee members and a few former delegates. Each district holds four G.S.R. meetings a year and there are two G.S.R. assemblies annually. Better communication is responsible for growth of contributions, up from \$1.43 per member in 1967 to \$2.70 per member in 1969.

—Betty R.

NOVA SCOTIA/NEWFOUNDLAND/LABRADOR — We are, and have been for some time, active in institution work in our area and cooperate with the alcohol and drug addiction rehabilitation programs. Both Nova Scotia and Newfoundland hold two-day roundups. They are primarily social gatherings, but it is here that each area agrees on agenda submissions for the fall conference.

—Ed MacD.

OHIO (Central & Southeast) — The Cambridge State Hospital in our area accepts all patients with an alcoholic problem. It enjoys an almost unparalleled relationship with A.A. groups which assumes responsibility for bi-weekly A.A. meetings in the alcoholic ward. Individuals from various groups contact patients from their home areas so that it is easier for them to become members of their local groups.

—Howard R.

OHIO (Northeastern) — Some of our members are involved on a personal basis with various alcoholism programs and this enables us to cooperate effectively with outside agencies. As a result we are now able to admit alcoholics to some general hospitals in the area. We are getting more spot announcements on radio and television as we concentrate more and more on communication.

—Shirley S.

OKLAHOMA — District workshops are paying dividends by providing greater stress on sponsorship of the individual and personal communication to the suffering alcoholic. Our P.I. coverage has produced an evergrowing public awareness of the A.A. program. TV spots and 30-minute tapes are on at regular intervals throughout the state. In addition, institutions are well covered with meetings.

—Jim D.

ONTARIO (Eastern) — There are 22 institutions being served by the G.S.R.'s in our area, not including those in Toronto which are served by Intergroup. This past fall, a full-day workshop on institutions was held. It was well attended and successful. Enthusiasm is growing in our area and public information activities are going well.

—Mel L.

ONTARIO (Northeastern) — Our P.I.C. and Institutions Committees are functioning well. We are in the process of setting up a program under which inmates who have been attending meetings will be contacted and taken to a meeting when they

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are released and go to another area. We are also working with our Indian groups, trying to carry the message and make them feel less isolated and left out.

—Hector L.

ONTARIO (Northwestern) — Our area is just becoming aware of the General Service Office and contributions are just beginning to come in. This is only our fifth year as an area and we are experiencing some growing pains. Our committee meets twice a year and there is good representation on the part of G.S.R.'s.

—Barry W.

PENNSYLVANIA (Eastern) — Some of our groups having a large attendance of more than 40 people have begun to split up and have three or four individual meetings on the same night. This allows a more relaxed feeling and greater participation. Following this conference there will be general service round-ups in four different locations of Eastern Pennsylvania where the delegate's report will be given.

—Lenore M.

PENNSYLVANIA (Western) — More of our members are now cooperating in whatever way they can with the stepped-up alcoholism assistance programs—sharing with the clergy, doctors and psychiatrists as well as the State Committee on Alcoholism. Our area is working to set up an annual assembly for G.S.R.'s, committeemen and delegates only, hoping to promote more interest in service and responsibility.

—Bob B.

QUEBEC (Northeastern) — It is as a result of good communications that an Indian Montagnais member who spoke French came out of a clinic and formed a group. Then he had the Serenity Prayer and Twelve Steps translated into the Montagnais language. We have held 14 public information meetings in the past year in schools and institutions as well as on television.

—Earl P.

TEXAS (Northeastern) — Believing that there is no more effective way of communications between human beings than the "face to face" and "elbow to elbow" fellowship of A.A. get together, we hold monthly round-robin meetings within most districts of our area. This gives encouragement to outlying groups and members and increases communications and co-operation throughout the area.

—Bill A.

TEXAS (Southeast) — The area assembly has a monthly sharing session in addition to quarterly meetings. This keeps interest high and alive, reminding us to keep the lines of communications open. Our P.I. Committees have good cooperation with news media. For this we are grateful, as we feel that a properly informed public can do much to help the sick alcoholic.

—Neal M.

UTAH — Many of our A.A. members attend the University of Utah School on Alcoholism & Other Drug Dependencies. They give a helping hand in many ways to help make it successful. Our central office and newsletter contribute a good deal to growth of A.A. and our members are becoming more aware of their effectiveness and thus making more use of them.

—George S.

VIRGINIA — We are working to increase contributions to the level of \$3 per member and also to encourage memorial contributions. Following the 1971 Conference we plan to set up area meetings for all G.S.R.'s at which time the delegate will

report on G.S.O. and other topics. Each year we also have a statewide convention, as well as district committee meetings.

—Joe B.

WASHINGTON — The little assembly at Spokane has been meeting twice a year for quite a while. The main part can be accomplished in one day, usually on a Saturday, although many stay over for Sunday breakfast. It is important that members can attend regardless of finances. There is no long trip and no special affair where admission is charged. Two more such assemblies have been started in our area this year.

—Shorty H.

WEST VIRGINIA — Communications mean to send as well as receive, and I have seen this in my own community where establishment of a 24-hour telephone answering service has helped to double the number of groups in the last two years. It lets us know whose hand is out for help. A public information committee has made progress with both radio and television and we are working to improve relations with outside agencies.

—Bob McCa.

WISCONSIN (Southern) — We feel that communication is the beginning of understanding and have set a goal of reaching people rather than things. We have spring and fall conferences for our members and work to maintain good relations with outside agencies which range from hospitals through social workers, the courts, private industry and other agencies in the field of alcoholism.

—Joe B.

ANONYMITY (cont'd from p. 13)

4. In visiting area assemblies, we at G.S.O. sometimes find communication difficult because only first names are used.

As we all know, the World Directories use full names, so they may serve as a communications tool within A.A. This is, of course, done with the approval of the General Service Conference.

So when we are speaking about Anonymity Within A.A., are we not really talking about using full names within A.A.? Let us think about it — we are not a secret society. Are we placing more importance than needed on names by not using them? We do want to increase communication, as our survival is based on the sharing of our experience, strength and hope with alcoholics. I personally feel I can share more fully with Grace B. if I knew her last name is Brown — and not try to guess whether it is Bennett — Brice — Benson — or what?

Perhaps it would be a real aid to communications if we clarified, by a sense of this Conference, whether we need be so anonymous within A.A., or whether, if we wish, we can freely use our full names, both in speaking, visiting and corresponding — within A.A.? How do you feel about it?

Perhaps, by finding some guidance on this question, we will improve communication within A.A., and it may be a part of the key to A.A. growth — both our own growth through easier sharing, and for the new members who are yet to come to us for help.

—Hazel R., G.S.O.

THE GENERAL SERVICE

A.A. World Services, Inc.

A.A. World Services, Inc. is responsible for the employment of all G.S.O. personnel (currently 42 full-time employees and 12 part-time), for the publishing and distribution of Conference-approved literature, and for the preparation and control of G.S.O.'s operating budget. It is a membership corporation, in effect a wholly owned subsidiary of the G.S.B.

As members of the corporation, the trustees of the General Service Board elect the seven A.A.W.S. directors at their annual meeting, following the General Service Conference in April.

Officers of the A.A.W.S., Inc. are elected by the directors at their meeting in May. Three of the current directors are also general service trustees; two others are chosen for their special knowledge and availability. The general manager, who serves as president, and the staff coordinator complete the Board of Directors.

Publishing: Sales for the year came to \$529,600, an increase of \$52,600 over 1969. Besides carrying its own costs, A.A.W.S. contributed \$50,000 to the General Fund to help defray costs of other services which voluntary contributions failed to meet. Distribution of all books, pamphlets and miscellaneous items in 1970 totaled 2,565,100 individual units. A.A.W.S. also distributed 195,200 free pieces of literature to service new groups and familiarize the general public with A.A. The free material carried inventory value of \$7,400.

Accounting: Supervised by Charlie Columbia, there are six full-time employees and one part-time. During 1970, this department processed and recorded over 14,920 orders and 19,310 contributions. It also acknowledged 7,000 Convention registrations and 4,220 housing requests.

Clerical/Steno: Madeline Whitlock heads up this department; now has 13 full-time and two part-time employees. Eight handle transcriptions, take minutes, cut stencils, type reports and route tapes and films. There are two clerk-typists. The file unit is made up of three girls who also do research on group histories and maintain G.S.O.'s archives. The balance includes our receptionist, and switchboard operator who also helps out with Spanish translations.

Records: In 1970 this department processed over 12,000 pieces of mail and from this, set up files on 1,274 groups. In addition, 10,000 other changes were made in our group records. Rose Failla, the manager, has four other employees in her department.

Shipping: There are seven full-time employees and nine part-time, including Manager Al Cryan and his assistant, Haywood Hicks. Mail processed last year amounted to 100,290 pieces (incoming) and 69,208 (outgoing mail, First Class). Literature orders accounted for 52,862 packages.

Production Editor: Nell Wing is production editor of the three editions of *Box 4-5-9* (English, French and Spanish). Besides other editing duties, she now serves as secretary to the general manager.

—Bob H.

LITERATURE DISTRIBUTED — 1970

BOOKS

Alcoholics Anonymous	54,725
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (Reg. Edition)	20,138
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (Gift Edition)	6,730
Alcoholics Anonymous Comes of Age	6,678
As Bill Sees It (A.A. Way of Life)	11,649
Alcoholics Anonymous — Spanish Edition	1,059

Total . . 100,979

PAMPHLETS

This is A.A.	182,989
A.A. — 44 Questions and Answers.	143,227
Is A.A. For You?	207,491
Young People and A.A.	74,883
A.A. for the Woman.	76,568
Alcoholism The Illness	91,381
The Alcoholic Husband	89,935
The Alcoholic Wife	65,937
Memo to an Inmate	27,502
Sedatives, Stimulants and the Alcoholic	81,896
The Jack Alexander Article About A.A.	55,800
The Fortune Story about A.A.	42,286
Letter to a Woman Alcoholic	62,924
Questions and Answers on Sponsorship	48,387
What Happened to Joe	81,299
It Happened to Alice	52,585
The A.A. Group	34,464
A.A. Tradition — How it Developed.	40,726
Inside A.A.	26,383
The G.S.R.	31,561
A.A. Service Manual.	4,083
The Twelve Concepts	1,308
A.A. and the Medical Profession	38,101
A.A. and the Alcoholic Employee	38,402
A Clergyman Asks About A.A.	44,261
A.A. In Prisons	13,262
A.A. In Hospitals	18,437
The Fellowship of A.A.	68,108
A.A. In Your Community	109,032
A.A. Survey (New)	18,773
Alcoholism is a Management Problem.	63,400
Foreign Translations	98,957

Total . . 2,034,348

MISCELLANEOUS

How it Works	88,049
Tapes of A.A. Talks	290
Wallet Cards — Two Fold	281,750
Wallet Cards — "I Am Responsible".	52,995
Parchment Scrolls	1,654
Newcomers' Meeting Kit	1,668
Group Handbook	2,250
Literature Racks	1,131

OFFICE AT WORK

Service Coordinator

The services that are provided by G.S.O. could be described as trying to meet the expressed needs of our Fellowship in ways which will best help to carry our message of recovery to the still sick alcoholic. Specific responsibilities of the coordinator include:

1. **Acting as a focal point for communication** between departments; Shipping, Accounting, Records, Clerical/Steno and the Staff.
2. **Box 4-5-9** (bi-monthly G.S.O. bulletin). A collection of material from the staff, from correspondence, from suggestions, from specific requests from members.
3. **World Directories** – Part I is distributed annually at no cost to all groups in the United States and Canada. Part II goes to all groups overseas. A.A. members, who are identified as such, can buy individual copies.
4. **Guidelines.** There are eight Guidelines distributed at no cost that have been compiled in the light of the 12 Traditions and shared experiences from groups and members.
5. **Tapes and Films.** There are tapes and a tape library available along with several films, and literature in Braille.
6. **Group Services.** When information is received about a new group, a copy of the **Group Handbook** (which is also available in French) is sent, as well as a complementary supply of literature.
7. **Literature Kits.** Numerous Literature Kits are available. Most of these are sent at no charge.
8. **Displays.** "Inside A.A." and Literature displays are sent to all A.A. conferences, conventions, and go out automatically at no charge when information is received.
9. **Service Meetings.** Service meetings are held every other week when the staff reviews a particular service with the staff member responsible for it. —Ann M.

Staff Coordinator

The staff coordinator is responsible for staff coverage of the office at all times and keeps a calendar on the bulletin board to record A.A. trips, days off, vacations and other staff activities.

There are eight staff members; each one is responsible for group correspondence in one of the eight geographic regions of the United States and Canada. In addition, each staff member has a service assignment.

G.S.O. is a center for sharing A.A. experience worldwide in many ways. We are always so happy to receive letters telling

how your group solved a particular problem because your experience can be passed along to another group. But there are other ways of sharing, and the more than 1000 visitors who came to G.S.O. last year contributed much to our A.A. storehouse.

One of the most delightful ways of sharing are the A.A. conventions and gatherings in which staff members are invited to participate. Last year the staff participated in 40 of these events. We bring back much A.A. news from each one of these trips.

There are two ways of sharing and communication within the office. The first is the daily circulation folder; each day the carbons of all letters written by each staff member, with the incoming letter attached, are placed in this folder.

The second way of sharing and communication within the office is the biweekly staff meeting. A Grapevine staff member joins the G.S.O. staff for these meetings, and each person reports on her assignment activities. Frequently letters that have difficult or unusual questions are brought to staff meetings for their group-conscience thinking and guidance for reply.

—Midge McF.

Conference

Our co-founder, Bill, left us on January 24, 1971, to continue his spiritual journey; since that time there seems to have been some unspoken questions about A.A.'s future. We need have no fear as a resolution offered by Bill and adopted at the Twentieth Anniversary Convention of A.A. in 1955 states: **"This Resolution authorizes the General Service Conference to act for Alcoholics Anonymous and become the successor to its co-founder."** It is important to remember that the purpose of the General Service Conference is to assume the responsibility of leadership for the founders of Alcoholics Anonymous.

Communication begins when G.S.O. receives notice of newly elected delegates, other officers, committee members and G.S.R.'s. All are placed on the mailing list, and appropriate material mailed to them from G.S.O.

The deadline for placing in the *World Directory* new delegates, new chairmen, new G.S.R.'s, new groups, etc., is *December 1* of each year. There are 90 delegates, 78 committee chairmen and 11,208 groups in the United States and Canada that appear in the *World Directory*. These figures should give you some idea of the work involved for the G.S.O. Records Department. Is it possible to schedule your election assemblies and advise G.S.O. early enough to meet the Directory deadline of December 1, so all your current "trusted servants" will properly appear in the Directory?

There are many ways that we can communicate, so let us all use the "key" to unlock the doors that have not as yet been opened.

—Waneta N.

Institutions

We now serve 767 A.A. groups in hospitals and rehabilitation centers with approximately 18,604 members, and 925 groups in correctional facilities. We also have 106 Institutions Committees and 28 institutions sponsors listed at G.S.O.

Many thousands of A.A. members have found sobriety in institutions. Today there are many rehabilitation centers for alcoholics and more and more we see A.A. members coming to us from these facilities. Also, in the past few years there has been great interest developed in municipal court programs and we are beginning to meet many new members who have found their way because they were "sentenced" to A.A.

More communication is needed between the non-A.A.'s working in rehabilitation centers and the A.A. members in the areas where these facilities are located. Many times those centers do not have an A.A. contract for referral, making the alcoholics' transition from the inside to the outside so much more difficult, and sometimes depriving them of A.A. sponsorship. We should be more aware of the alcoholics' needs when leaving these centers so they will find the hand of A.A. waiting for them.

—Mary Ellen U.

Training Program

My training program covered a three-month period and was a comprehensive, on-the-job study of all aspects of G.S.O. and its services. The staff coordinator reviewed incoming mail with me each day for several weeks, illustrating how G.S.O. assists A.A. groups and members by sharing experiences passed along from other groups and members. Within the first few weeks, I visited with each staff member and department head who described his (or her) specific assignment.

Early in my training program, I began to dictate some simple letters acknowledging contributions and records information. By the end of the first month, I had been assigned to correspond with the Southeast Region and was experiencing the joy of receiving letters from many new A.A. friends welcoming me and wishing me well in my new job at G.S.O.

Meetings of various types provided another medium for learning. In January, I attended meetings of several Trustees' Committees. The A.A. World Services monthly meeting provided an excellent means for learning about service, as well as attendance at biweekly staff meetings in which staff members share current information on assignments and ask for group guidance on specific questions.

Through the cooperation and encouragement of each staff member and each department head, I learned a great deal about G.S.O. services during my training program. This program ended early in April, but each day is a new beginning, another chance to learn and to serve.

—Valerie S.

Public Information

This service has been very active in the past year. The general public obviously has a growing interest in and knowledge of A.A. It is the responsibility of this service to provide information about A.A. to the public. Those who contact us may be divided into the following categories:

1. **Inquiries.** Some 8,500 persons contacted us, about 2,500 more than last year: students, teachers, families of alcoholics, nurses, etc. All were answered with a letter and appropriate literature. Inquiries about other fellowships were also answered and referrals made if information was available. Among those who contacted the P.I. desk for information were: writers, publishers, radio and TV programmers.

The Annual Report and annual letter on the Anonymity Tradition and the reasons for it were mailed to the news media during the past year. Also, many press releases were mailed in conjunction with A.A.'s 35th Anniversary International Convention. Hundreds of press clippings were received as a result.

The P.I.C. handled all media coverage in connection with Bill's death. Some time ago an obituary for Bill was distributed to the wire services, radio and TV networks. An accompanying letter signed by both Bill and Lois, gave permission for the disclosing of his full name at the time of his death. This obituary was updated periodically. Special telegrams were sent to President Nixon, Premier Trudeau, Gov. Rockefeller and Mayor Lindsay. Lois received condolences from each. Worthy of separate mention was the *New York Times* obituary which was written by John S., an A.A. member.

The total press coverage was most heartwarming, and we are well aware that many of you were responsible for local press coverage. The P.I. Committee also distributed a news release in conjunction with the memorial services held around the world on February 14. More than 1,000 press clippings and articles have been received to date, and we feel more will come. There were also many requests for information about Dr. Bob and this was given to the communications media.

—Eleanor N.

Overseas

Today there are 3,559 groups overseas with a membership of 66,632. Exciting things have developed through the years and since the first World Service Meeting held in October, 1969, A.A. growth has been burgeoning. Here are some of the highlights:

Asia: There are about 60 members in South Vietnam, with ten groups reported. A.A.'s there continue to ask for information on how to start groups and how to get started as Loners.

Australia: The Australian Service Conference voted unanimously in favor of establishing a G.S.B. in Australia, with a

General Service Office to be opened later in Sydney.

Brazil: The Literature Distribution Center is located at Sao Paulo, where there is an active committee and office. Last year the Big Book (first 11 chapters) was translated into Portuguese and is now being distributed from the L.D.C.

El Salvador: Their G.S.B. is getting underway. We have sent them a suggested proposal for A.A. General Service structure in all of Central America. Currently the G.S.O. in San Salvador is answering all mail forwarded them from G.S.O. in New York.

England: An A.A. member in show business in London had his anonymity broken at the public level. We shared the steps taken by our P.I.C. regarding anonymity breaks and they are following the experience here in the U.S. and Canada.

Finland: For the first time, their G.S.B. has invited a staff member to attend their Conference.

Ireland: An office has been established in Dublin to service A.A. throughout the country; delegates elected from the four provinces. Their G.S. Conference meets twice a year.

Mexico: The Big Book in Spanish is being printed and distributed by the Literature Distribution Center in Mexico. The G.S.O. in Mexico is apparently running smoothly.

Sweden: The Big Book has been translated; it is in manuscript form, and an initial meeting has been held with regard to helping A.A. in Sweden print and distribute it.

One of the highlights of my assignment this year was a trip to Finland, where I visited meetings in Helsinki before leaving on a seven day trip through Norway and Sweden.

Meetings in Finland start at 7 o'clock and they drink coffee and chat until 7:30. Then the discussion meeting starts and lasts until 9 p.m. A.A.'s in Finland were all very anxious to hear about A.A. in America. They feel very close to A.A.'s here and they want to hear everything about it.

A.A. is very well established in Finland and their office certainly reflects their efficiency. In Finland, as well as Norway, I had an opportunity to visit alcoholic clinics. These accept alcoholics only, are for both men and women and have A.A. meetings.

I had the pleasure of visiting the General Service Office in Helsinki. It services all the Finnish and Swedish groups in Finland, as well as the Finnish and Swedish groups in Sweden with literature. Veikko, the World Service Delegate, is office manager, and there are two A.A. staff members who handle literature orders.

Following our visit to Norway and Sweden we returned to Finland for the convention at Imatra, a small town near the Russian border. Before the convention there was a press conference in Helsinki which was attended by 17 representatives from the press. More than 600 people attended the convention. They were enthusiastic, warm and friendly. I participated in panels on A.A. cooperation in the field of alcoholism and public information and they all wanted to hear about Bill and his work. It was a wonderful privilege to visit A.A.'s in Finland and I know now that no matter where we go we have a home and family in A.A.

—Beth K.

Professional Relations

The trustees decided in January, 1970, to separate A.A.'s relations with professional groups and outside organizations from the Public Information Committee. The staff assignment was created to handle the correspondence and projects of concern to this new committee.

A memo explaining that the Board had formed a committee on Professional Relations which will seek to create mutual understanding and cooperation between A.A. and professional groups was mailed to the National Council on Alcoholism and affiliate members with N.C.A.'s "Friday Letter" which goes to all N.C.A. members.

We also mailed such a letter to the 53 directors of state and provincial alcoholism programs affiliated with the North American Association of Alcoholism Programs (NAAAP). We asked for printed material about their programs and to be put on their mailing lists. The response to both the memo and the letter has been tremendous; highly enthusiastic about A.A. and the kind of cooperation that A.A. has given in the different parts of the continent over the years.

The NAAAP has asked A.A. to prepare a paper for consideration by the program committee for the NAAAP Annual Meeting in Hartford, Conn., Sept. 7, 1971. Such a paper will be prepared and submitted for consideration.

There have been several meetings of A.A.'s who wear "two hats" around the country. The purpose of the meetings was for sharing experience as A.A. members who are also working as professionals in the field of alcoholism — in industry, in hospitals or prisons, or in the agencies.

We have prepared a list of groups and organizations concerned with the problem of alcoholism.

The Professional Exhibit was shown at eight national meetings of professional organizations.

Cora Louise B.

Loners

There are approximately 450 Loners on the General Service Board mailing list; 40 are Spanish and 16 are French.

As a result of an article entitled "Makes Contact" in the January, 1971 issue of the A.A. Grapevine, it was suggested that if anyone was interested he could contact G.S.O. and become a Loner Sponsor, which is participating in Twelfth Step work through correspondence. The response to this suggestion has been overwhelming and we now have about 275 Loner Sponsors. These members do have access to A.A. group meetings, but like to carry the A.A. message to Loners via correspondence. Loners and Loner Sponsors are prolific writers and through A.A. literature and Twelfth Step letters, they stay sober, a day at a time.

Beth K.

Internationalists

Our Internationalists are really Loners-at-sea instead of ashore. Approximately 407 seagoing A.A.'s make up this group which carries the A.A. message around the world.

Their meeting list, and A.A. phone book is the World Directory. We also provide a list of names and mailing addresses of other Internationalists, and the Internationalists' *Round Robin*, a newsletter, is issued six times a year. *Box 4-5-9* goes to them six times a year also, alternating months with the *Round Robin*, so they correspond with the staff member assigned to the Internationalists. This A.A. sharing is a two-way street, and the hand of A.A. reaches out in both directions.

Cora Louise B.

International Conventions

The Convention Committee is grateful to report that the 1970 Anniversary Convention, held in Miami Beach, Florida, July 3 through July 5 was a success, both Fellowship-wise and financially. The budget was based on 9,000 registrants and there were actually 10,700, about 300 more than in Toronto in 1965.

The 1975 International Convention will be held July 4 through July 6, 1975. A letter concerning the site for the 1975 International Convention was mailed out to all delegates containing a bid questionnaire. Questionnaires and bids have been received from:

Phoenix, Arizona	New York, N.Y.
Denver, Colorado	Portland, Oregon
Chicago, Illinois	Montreal, Quebec
Detroit, Michigan	San Antonio, Texas
Seattle, Washington	

Bids will be considered by the Convention Site Committee at the 21st General Service Conference. Following presentations, the Committee will vote on 1st, 2nd and 3rd preferences as to the convention site. These will be presented to the Board of Trustees at its annual meeting in April following the Conference.

—Bob H., Convention Chairman

1975 Convention Site

During the question-and-answer period following Bob's report on the 1970 International Convention at Miami, several delegates voiced the opinion that at the 1975 Convention the number of non-A.A. speakers be limited, and that they be people who are interested in A.A. and alcoholism; that there be at least one A.A. meeting held at the same time non-A.A.'s are speaking so that members always have a choice; and that the

speakers at the Sunday morning spiritual panel be A.A. members.

Delegates selected the following cities in order of preference as their choice for the 1975 A.A. Convention: Denver, Seattle and Detroit. Following the Conference, Bob, Kleina and Dennis visited Denver to inspect hotel and convention facilities. Their report will be forthcoming shortly.

Grapevine

The year 1970 opened with Grapevine circulation at 54,800 and closed with the December issue at 57,700, a growth of 6%. Circulation of the Grapevine has increased at approximately this rate over the last three years. This growth is most gratifying because it has been achieved without undue promotion.

We believe that the present enthusiasm for the Grapevine stems from a feeling on the part of our Fellowship that the Grapevine is truly *their* magazine.

This feeling results in a high degree of reader participation in Grapevine content. In the last several years, and especially this year, the number of manuscripts and other items offered for publication has greatly increased. Thus we are able to choose material of a better quality than ever before, and we have on hand a reserve of excellent Grapevine material.

In striving to reflect A.A. thinking, we often publish a controversial piece, with the understanding that opinions expressed are those of an individual A.A. member. Usually such a piece will bring a number of manuscripts and letters in response, all packed with good A.A. philosophy. Throughout the year we have been able to link together a number of such pieces so as to form a sort of symposium on the subject. Outstanding examples were a section of the January issue devoted to "The Search For Spiritual Experience"; in the May issue, a section devoted to "Alcohol and Pills"; in June, as the result of a piece on profanity at meetings, we were able to put together a section reflecting extraordinary basic A.A. thinking; in July, five pieces were linked together as a presentation on "Prisons and Institutions"; in August, "Psychiatry and Alcoholism," in September, a section on "Ego," that bugaboo for all alcoholics; in October, "On Helping Others . . . Professionally," and finally, the March, 1971, issue of the Grapevine, a memorial to Bill W.

The editors are happy to note that the magazine itself pays its own way, though rapidly rising costs may change that picture in the future. Contributing to the Grapevine's financial picture are several special items we make available. Most notable: the 1971 Calendar order of 15,000 was sold out. The sale of our book, *Best Cartoons from the Grapevine*, has sold nearly 6,000 copies to date, out of a total printing of 20,000 copies. It continues a steady sale of over fifty copies a week. *The Best of Bill* also continues to sell well. On the whole, the Grapevine appears to be very healthy.

—Jack M. & Paula C., Editors

Delegates Only Meeting

The 21st General Service Conference area delegates opened their meetings with a moment's silence in memory of Bill W., co-founder, Bern Smith, Bill W., and Hugh S. — it was resolved to place a gift in the memorial fund in their memory.

The following resolutions were acted upon:

1. That the General Service Office have the right to choose the hotel for the 1972 Conference with a unanimously strong recommendation that they consider a site other than the Hotel New Yorker.
2. Passed a resolution of thanks to the G.S.O. staff for all their efforts in making this Conference a success.
3. Expressed gratitude and appreciation to those delegates who served on the Task Force.
4. Passed the following resolution:

In recognition of the importance of keeping past delegates informed and involved, it is recommended that past delegates receive the G.S.O. *Quarterly Report*.

5. Unanimously agreed that the Sunday get-acquainted meeting be continued. The delegates expressed a desire to use the 'bell system' so that more members would have an opportunity to participate.
6. Elected Bob McA., West Virginia, as the 1972 area delegates' chairman.
*Margaret C., chairman
"Delegates Only" meeting*

Some Advisory Actions

USE OF A.A. NAME

Following some discussion of a local problem involving the alleged use of the A.A. name in a fund-raising appeal, delegates reaffirmed the right of any A.A. member or General Service Board member to serve and have his name placed on the letterhead of another organization when not identified as an A.A. member, or a member of A.A.'s General Service Board.

The Conference reaffirmed that the A.A. name never be linked with other organizations for fund-raising purposes.

Also recommended:

... That the subject of "clubs" be a major item on the 1972 Conference agenda.

... That the use of full names and addresses, *where indicated*, could improve communications within A.A.

... That specific time be allotted to all speakers and the "bell" be rung, no matter who is speaking.

... recommended that delegates obtain the thinking of their area on possible uses of the Bill W. Memorial fund, and communicate their findings to the trustees for their guidance.

... That the idea of considering February 14th, or the month of February as a permanent special memorial time for Bill and others who have departed, be placed on the agenda of the 1972 Conference.

COMMUNICATION (*cont'd. from p. 11*)

Mutual Communication

How do we increase mutual understanding between professionals and A.A. members? Through more and better communication!

Let me repeat the first three points I made almost eleven years ago at the Long Beach Convention — in regard to what is needed in our relationship to the non-A.A. world.

1. Better communication at the local community level. This is where the average A.A. needs to work at it, but such communication is needed at all levels within A.A.
2. Better understanding and acceptance of non-A.A. agency viewpoints. A.A.'s want to have A.A. understood and accepted. That's all the agencies want with regard to their programs.
3. More appreciation for other-than-A.A. ways of helping alcoholics.

Many professionals need a better understanding of A.A. too. So we need real two-way communication — *talking and listening* to each other.

However, lest I be misunderstood, I believe that A.A.'s no. 1 concern should be the quality of A.A. itself — upon *being A.A. at its best!* This is the most important contribution which A.A. can make to the total field.

Nevertheless, I believe that A.A. will not have its *best* future unless it *also* — *and within the Traditions* — continually concerns itself with good two-way communication with the non-A.A. alcoholism world.

As for just *how* to cooperate, I believe the specifics will emerge as we achieve more and better communication. Communication first! Acceptable ways of cooperation will follow.
—Milton Maxwell, Ph.D.

QUESTIONS AND ANSWERS

Q. Are reprints available of Milton Maxwell's Grapevine article on anonymity?

A. The Grapevine does not reprint articles. If there is a great demand, GV articles are reprinted by A.A. World Services, Inc.

Q. Is there a recent picture of Bill W. available to A.A. members?

A. The picture we have available was taken about ten years ago and sells for \$1.50.

Q. Should an A.A. group contribute to an outside agency?

A. The delegates said no, unanimously.

Q. Is it possible to have the deadline for World Directory cards changed to January 15 from December 1? Many groups elect G.S.R.'s in December.

A. If G.S.O. made this change, the date of issue would be much later than it is now. We have tried to issue the Directory in time for the annual Conference. Show of hands indicated that most areas hold their G.S.R. elections and election assemblies before December 1. About five or six hold them after December 1. The great majority elect in September, October and November.

Q. On which side of the triangle should Recovery, Unity and Service be placed? Is there any reason for this particular position?

A. Recovery is at the base, Unity at the left; Service at the right. We could not have unity or service without a recovery base. And Unity and Service are equal.

Q. What general criteria and qualifications are used in the selection of G.S.O. staff and how are they selected?

A. They should be active and dedicated A.A. members with some experience in service work. Most of our staff have had some service work or intergroup experience. Some sort of office or business experience is helpful. A reasonable length of sobriety is necessary. They should be mature and able to get along well with all kinds of people. They should also be personable and good speakers. A.A.'s from places other than New York are welcomed as applicants.

Q. How can we stop a rest home from putting "Alcoholics Anonymous" information with phone number only in the local telephone book preceding the Alcoholics Anonymous phone number?

A. Rest homes are not A.A. facilities or A.A. service centers; therefore, it was felt that everything possible should be done to avoid having them listed as Alcoholics Anonymous in local telephone directories. Some suggestions:

(1) The delegate armed with G.S.O.'s Guidelines on Rehabilitation Centers and A.A. could meet with the directors of the rest home and discuss this situation, (2) Place the A.A. phone number under the initials "A.A." as well as the alphabetical listing under "Alcoholics Anonymous."

Q. Could we have a show of hands as to the number of delegates that are required to give an exact statement of their expenses at the Conference to their committees?

A. One delegate was required to do this; five or six submit this information on their own initiative; others are allotted a certain amount and not required to give an exact accounting.

Q. I would like some answers on redistricting an area of about 300 groups. Also, do you think we should increase or decrease the amount of committee members?

A. It was suggested that committee members be increased. In large areas which are difficult to reach, one district could be broken into two and the committee enlarged. This will result in better turnouts at meetings and better coverage. The delegate asking the question was referred to other delegates who have recently redistricted their areas.

Q. What is the opinion of bringing members of prison groups to speak at outside A.A. meetings?

A. It was the consensus that when A.A. members from prisons are permitted to attend outside A.A. meetings, the results have worked out well and this seemed to create no particular problem.

Q. In our city we have a central office which covers pretty much the delegate's area. We have two paid A.A. members manning the office, and we were wondering if it is feasible to have a National Group Life, Health and Hospital Policy. Most group policies are only initiated with at least three members, and an overall national group would work fine.

A. A previous study has indicated that this could not be done on a national basis because each central office that has employees is completely autonomous. They will have to be related via a common charter to qualify for a national policy.

Q. Whose responsibility is it to turn in the names of the newly elected delegate and chairman of the area committee? The new secretary does not take office until January, and this is too late.

A. The current secretary.

FROM THE CONFERENCE FLOOR

Q. How can we make better use of the declaration of Responsibility at group level: make part of Preamble, bring closer to Traditions?

A. It was suggested this could be the responsibility of sponsors and the group as a whole. The "Responsibility Plaque" is available from G.S.O. and can be displayed at group meetings, or wherever A.A.'s gather.

Q. Will a movie be made of Bill's life story?

A. Perhaps, sometime. There are no such plans at this time (1971).

Q. Would it be a good idea to consider February 14 as a permanent special day within the Fellowship for appreciation for those who have gone before? Or, since Bill often spoke of the "language of the heart," could February be designated as a special month in A.A. for the above purpose?

A. There was not much reaction to this question, but it was suggested that some thought be given to it for further discussion at next year's Conference.

Q. Can we have a show of hands on the question "Should G.S.O. accept contributions from clubs"?

A. There was much discussion on the subject of clubs, but no conclusion reached. It was decided that this subject be an item on the 1972 Conference agenda.

Q. Would it be possible to arrange for "thoughts for the day" telephone recordings that could be reached by dialing a certain number?

A. It is possible, but it would have to be arranged for locally.

Q. When a member has a dual problem with alcohol and drugs, should the member talk about both problems at an A.A. meeting?

A. Show of hands — the majority felt that this was up to the individual (and to the group, of course).

Q. Why can't we have examples of what is considered Tradition breaks included in the Guidelines on Clubs?

A. These will be included in the forthcoming Illustrated Traditions pamphlet, and they can be included in the Guidelines on Clubs, if the delegates send samples from their areas.

Q. When there is an anonymity break, who is responsible for approaching the offender?

A. If an anonymity break comes to the attention of G.S.O., we write to the person whose anonymity was broken, to the media involved, with a copy to the area delegate.

Q. Is there anything against taking up a collection at an area convention?

A. A show of hands indicated that about 30 areas take up collections at these meetings.

Q. At all open meetings the hat is passed. Isn't this wrong?

A. This seems to be a universal custom.

Q. What is the policy of A.A. on jewelry, cufflinks, tie clasps?

A. G.S.O. does not sell this material, but we do have available a list of suppliers, which is sent to A.A.'s upon request.

Q. In 1970, we recommended that the area committee consider a symposium of services that would include an educational program for G.S.R.'s in the working of their group relations to G.S.O. I would like to hear some discussion on how to go about this. Are there any guidelines?

A. It was suggested that state committee members be encouraged to extend an open invitation to G.S.R.'s to hold workshops. There is material on this subject included in the Conference Kit and the A.A. Service Manual. The delegate who asked this question was referred to other delegates for sharing of experience.

Q. Should A.A. meeting lists also include Al-Anon and Alateen meetings?

A. Show of hands indicated that the majority do. It was suggested that Al-Anon's permission be obtained before doing so.

Q. Can we eliminate the term "ex" in defining former servants? Can't we use the term "former" and "past" for identification purposes?

A. The term "past" is used for identification purposes in the A.A. Service Manual.

Q. Is there any further study on a paperback of the Big Book?

A. There is no such study at this moment (1971).

Q. What can we do to get our past delegates active again, once they have been to New York and feel their job is done?

A. Some suggestions were: (1) Rotate to chairman of the area committee, (2) Have past delegates organize state-wide meetings, (3) Keep them active as Grapevine chairmen and Public Information chairmen, (4) Have past delegates attend the assemblies, (5) Invite them to serve as advisers to state assemblies, (6) See that they are involved in institutional work. It was further suggested that some ideas be sent to G.S.O., and perhaps this subject can be discussed next year.

TRUSTEES REPORT ON

Report of the Chairman

Once again, it is my privilege to report to you on the state of the Fellowship of Alcoholics Anonymous as seen from the vantage point of the Board of Trustees and as reflected in the actions taken by the Board since we last met.

During the past year, the Board, along with the entire Fellowship, suffered tremendous loss, not only with the passing of Bill, but with the death of Bern Smith and the retirement of Archie Roosevelt, both of whom gave freely of their wise counsel and guidance since the earliest days of A.A. Also retired from the Board during the past year were Bob Morse, because of ill health, and Judge Murtagh. Their wisdom and strength will be sorely missed in future deliberations of your Board of Trustees. We did, however, gain two new trustees, elected at last year's Conference. These are Class A trustee Arthur J. Miles, our new treasurer, and Class B trustee-at-large Jim Hiers.

A.A. In Excellent Shape

At the moment A.A. is, in your Board's opinion, in excellent shape, despite the grievous losses just mentioned. We are somewhat concerned that group contributions still are substantially below the cost of group services.

There isn't time enough to mention all of the questions that have come before your Board for consideration and discussion during the past year. Nor can I go into all of the subjects explored or the problems examined. I would, however, like to touch briefly on a few of them.

As you of Panel 20 remember, a task force was formed last year to review the procedures and mechanics of the Conference. The first meeting under the chairmanship of Andy A., was held during the Conference itself and the last was during the Miami Convention. You will be hearing from your Policy Committee later regarding some of the conclusions and ideas that the task force came up with during the past year. All of these, of course, are a result of the suggestions and ideas put forth by you delegates.

Also during the past year, the Board formed two new committees of its own. These are the Long-Range Planning Committee, which is concerned with conditions and events that we will have to meet in future years and the Professional Relations Committee which was formed at the suggestion of the Public Information Committee. It was felt that our relationship with the many other organizations interested in the field of alcoholism had become so numerous and important that these could not be adequately handled in conjunction with P.I. activities, but deserved the services of a full committee. I should also like to mention that the Miami Convention was an outstanding success. It was even profitable, but you will be hearing more about this later also. It is enough for me to say now that 10,750 people were registered compared to the 10,450 who registered in Toronto in 1965. Work has already started on our 1975 Convention, and we will determine the site for it this year.

With Bill's passing, the Board has also been faced with the question of what to do with the memorial contributions being sent in by A.A. members from all parts of the world. These are being set aside in a special fund which will in all likelihood reach a total of between \$25,000 and \$30,000. The fund is to be administered by the Board of Trustees; we will have an opportunity of discussing this later also.

Biography of Bill

Another question that has come before us since Bill's death has to do with a biography of his life. We have been approached by several authors and publishing companies, and we will continue to look into the matter to try and determine the best course of action for us to take.

Finally, your Board passed a motion, subject to Conference approval, that its quarterly Board meetings be held on the fifth Monday following the end of the preceding quarter, instead of on the fourth Monday as has been done theretofore. This is being done in order to give our accountants more time to prepare their financial reports for our meetings. This change will not, however, affect the April meeting of the Board which will continue to be held on the Saturday following the Conference. I would like to ask you for your confirmation now. Are there any questions? May I have a show of hands?

*John L. Norris, M.D., chairman
General Service Board*

Professional Relations

Interest and involvement in the field of alcoholism and treatment for the sick alcoholic are exploding throughout North America. Because of the challenge this interest poses for A.A. and the potential volume of work involved, the trustees voted last January to separate from the P.I. Committee A.A.'s relations with professional groups and outside organizations. A new committee on Professional Relations was formed to concern itself with both the problem and the vast potential for A.A. that this activity presents.

A.A. is the oldest, probably the best-known and most respected organization dealing with alcoholics; A.A. is available almost everywhere and therefore will probably be the first referral source that occurs to most professionals. These professionals may not always understand A.A.'s traditional ways of functioning and may expect, or at least ask us to perform in ways that are either new for us or, in some cases, impossible. We have our traditional guidelines to help us find creative and productive ways of cooperating without affiliating.

The committee is deeply interested in having the Professional Exhibit well-manned by experienced A.A.'s from the community. Whenever possible, delegates, ex-delegates, and members of the P.I.C. might be interested in manning the booth. We also discussed new ideas for a replacement for the present

PROGRESS OF THE FELLOWSHIP

Exhibit and would anticipate that a new one will be available in the next six months.

The committee has recommended that G.S.O. provide guidelines for A.A. cooperation with voluntary and tax-supported alcoholism agencies and facilities. This has been postponed until we can evaluate the replies to our correspondence with the N.C.A. and NAAAP program directors, and until after the General Service Conference meeting.

Also recommended was a pamphlet on "A.A. and Professionals in the Alcoholism Field." The committee felt that the pamphlet should dwell on what A.A.'s responsibility is in relation to the professional and explain to him what A.A. is, what it can do, and what it cannot do, and the ways in which A.A. can cooperate within the Traditions.

We appointed a subcommittee to study the question of the proposed association of A.A. members who wear "two hats" and to report their suggestions at the next committee meeting.

*Steve O., chairman
Trustees' Professional Relations Committee*

Policy

The Trustees' Policy Committee has been in existence since 1955. It has definitely demonstrated its value in the 16 years as a clearinghouse for discussion and review of matters that are to be referred to the General Service Board. It serves as a filter for all matters of A.A. policy and Tradition. Items for discussion and review are often selected from A.A.W.S., Grapevine and Conference reports, as well as from reports received from the G.S.B. committees, namely, Finance, Literature, Long-Range Planning, Nominating, Professional Relations and Public Information. At each meeting the regional trustees and general service trustee-at-large give brief reports of their activities.

During the past year, the committee met in October and January on the Sunday before the Board meetings. All trustees, directors, G.S.O. and Grapevine staff members, and members of all the various Trustees' Committees were invited to these meetings. At each meeting 35 to 45 were present, and each meeting lasted approximately four hours. A "town meeting" format was used, which allowed for the expression of a broad range of opinions and recommendations.

Some of the subjects discussed at Policy meetings this past year were:

1. A filmstrip explaining the structure of A.A.
2. The theme and agenda of the 21st General Service Conference.
3. The preparation of TV spot announcements to present accurately A.A. to the public.

4. Future policy concerning agenda and meetings of International Conventions with particular reference to guest speakers, taping and panoramic pictures.
5. An anonymity statement to be presented to the Conference.
6. Ways to express gratitude to the longtime members of A.A.

A short memorial was held for Bill W. at the Policy meeting on January 31. Many present expressed their deep love and gratitude for what Bill had meant in their own personal lives and to the Fellowship. He was a regular attendee at Policy meetings, and his wise counsel will indeed be missed.

*-Katharine P., chairman
Trustees' Policy Committee*

Long-Range Planning

We live not only in a time of accelerating technological change but a time in which the once-familiar patterns of society are rapidly shifting. It has become evident from lessons of the past that we must learn to recognize and deal with these changes if we are to survive and grow—whether as individuals or as a fellowship. Thus the Long-Range Planning Committee has been formed—so that our Fellowship of Alcoholics Anonymous may be better able to cope with conditions and events that may be faced with in future years.

Your Long-Range Planning Committee is not so much concerned with action as it is with ideas. It has been purposely kept small to encourage creative thinking and allow flexible, freewheeling expression, as well as to enable us to bring in A.A. members, professional people and others whose ideas should be heard without making the meetings too large and unwieldy.

There have been four meetings of the Long-Range Planning Committee or "Futures" Committee since its formation last year. Each of these has proved rewarding and informative. Each has tended to bring up more questions than it has been able to find answers for. In short, we admit that we have a way to go.

There have been many areas of discussion. Some points are very important while others may seem minor, especially at a time when A.A. continues to prosper and grow more than ever before. Yet it is conceivable that any one or combination of these small problems could take hold and cause our Fellowship real trouble. In some cases we may be listening to a boy cry wolf when there is no wolf. Yet we *must* listen. While it is important for us to love our Fellowship, it is *vital* that we never permit ourselves to become complacent. We will not, if the Long-Range Planning Committee has its way, for it is the responsibility of this committee to provide that self-criticism without which no society can long endure.

*-John L. Norris, M.D., chairman
General Service Board*

Literature

The Trustees' Literature Committee reviews all suggestions for new A.A. Conference-approved literature, all suggested revisions to existing material, and approves the contents of any new book or pamphlet. It works with the Conference Committee on Literature; these two committees are also in touch by mail throughout the year. Following is a report of some of our activities during the last year:

1. **Member's-Eye View of Alcoholic Anonymous.** Approved by last year's Conference; now in distribution.
2. **Illustrated Traditions Pamphlet.** Drawings and text have been approved by the Trustees' Committee and forwarded to the Conference Committee for their comments. It should be ready for publishing soon.
3. **A.A. for the Woman.** A suburban housewife's story will be added in the next printing of this pamphlet.
4. **How We Stay Sober.** A first draft of this booklet is now being reviewed by the trustees' Literature Committee.
5. **Came To Believe.** The response to requests for material from A.A.'s has been gradual but heartwarming. It now looks like we have enough shared experience, and it will be distributed soon to both committees for their comments.
6. **Why Alcoholics Anonymous is Anonymous and Problems Other Than Alcohol.** At the suggestion of the 20th Conference, these two Grapevine reprints by Bill have been added to the A.A.W.S. literature order blank.
7. **A.A. and the Armed Services.** Originally, it was felt that there was need for a pamphlet addressed to the higher echelons of the armed services as an encouragement to have A.A. groups on their bases. It is felt that something similar to "Memo to an Inmate" would be an effective way of carrying the A.A. message to the armed services. This suggestion will be forwarded to the Conference Committee on Literature for their opinion before we proceed with the pamphlet. Then a writer will be assigned and stories will be obtained.

—Austin MacCormick, *Chairman*
Trustees' Literature Committee

Finance & Budgetary

The financial picture for 1970 was quite similar in net results to that being reported by most of the business corporations throughout the country. Total income was up nicely, but total expenses were up even higher. Net sales for the year increased by \$52,600 over 1969 (11%) and contributions were in excess of 1969 by \$37,500 (9.4%). Total income, comprised of Publishing gross profit, contributions and the net proceeds from the 35th Anniversary Convention, was in excess of 1969 by \$75,800. Total expenses, excluding construction costs related to moving the office, increased by \$81,300. This increase was due to A.A. growth, some non-recurring expenses connected with the move and the higher cost of doing business — generally referred to as inflation.

To sum up the total results of the year's operations, including construction and moving costs, the Group Fund deficit (\$56,900) and the General Fund deficit (\$149,500) was offset in part by A.A. World Services, Inc., net income (\$74,900), leaving a total net deficit in the amount of \$131,400 as compared to a net income of \$8,700 for 1969.

The 1971 G.S.O. budget was reviewed by the Finance Committee and has been approved. Overall income is budgeted 5% higher than 1970, a conservative estimate. Expenses are budgeted 7.9% higher than 1970 actual, excluding the 1970 construction and moving costs. The major increases are in salaries (one additional staff member, one additional shipping clerk and an allowance for seniority increases and cost of living adjustments); shipping and mailing expenses to allow for increased parcel post rates and increased activity; rent and electricity to reflect the higher cost of new space for the entire year, and an increase in other expense to allow for the higher cost of doing business.

Arthur Miles, *Chairman*
Trustees' Finance Committee

Public Information

The P.I.C. embarked upon the following actions in the past year:

1. A concise statement was prepared, in accordance with a 1970 Conference advisory action, to explain the A.A. Tradition of anonymity. This statement, in wallet-card form, will be presented to the Conference P.I.C. for approval. (See p. 37 for Conference Action)
2. The anonymity letter sent annually to the communications media was revised in order to clarify the Tradition.
3. As recommended by the 1970 Conference, a new memorandum was prepared and added to the P.I. Rit: "Memo to Members Participating in Radio and TV Shows."
4. Plans were approved for several TV spots that will give an accurate picture of the alcoholic recovered in A.A., without breaking anonymity at the public level.
5. A statement on anonymity, written for the Grapevine, was approved by the Policy Committee and the Board. It will be presented to the Conference P.I.C. for their approval. (See p. 37 for Conference Action)
6. The Board approved, for submission to this Conference, plans for a new A.A. survey of its own membership, in order to show the active alcoholic exactly what sort of people belong to the Fellowship. Since all questionnaires filled out for this survey will be unsigned, the Anonymity Tradition will be fully observed.

In addition to the above, P.I.C. activities include the following:

1. **All media were notified of Bill W.'s death.** Cables were sent to A.A. service centers in 25 foreign countries asking them to advise G.S.O. of any memorial-service plans. A release on the worldwide memorial services of February 14 was given to the press.

2. The 35th Anniversary Convention received widespread and mostly favorable publicity, with excellent cooperation from everyone.
3. A.A.'s Annual Report to the public was sent to all media. Material from this report appeared in at least 119 newspapers throughout the U.S. and Canada; U.P.I. gave us an excellent story.
4. The 1970 Conference recommended that a small folder be considered for use in schools. Under the title "Student's Guide to A.A.," this folder will soon be ready for the printer.
5. Bimonthly issues of the P.I. Bulletin were prepared and sent to local P.I.C.'s, intergroups, central offices, and others concerned with P.I. work.
6. The P.I.C. is working toward the development of a long-range plan for A.A. public information.

—Bayard P., Chairman
Trustees' P.I. Committee

World Service Meeting

As you will recall, the first World Service Meeting was held in New York, in October of 1969. This may well have been the most important event in A.A. history since the first North American General Service Conference more than twenty years ago. It sought to bring unity to A.A. worldwide, as the North American Conference brought unity to us here.

For three days of concentrated working sessions, the 27 elected delegates from 12 countries and one zone joined with delegates from this General Service Conference to share experience, strength and hope with each other and with Bill, the trustees of the General Service Board, A.A.W.S. directors, G.S.O. and Grapevine staffs.

After three days of reports, workshops and sharing of experience in informal sessions, the delegates at the final session approved six advisory actions regarding the future of the World Service Meeting. Among these, they agreed that the meeting was worthwhile and that the next meeting should be held in October, 1972 in New York City. Delegates also agreed to the formation of four committees to conduct the business of the World Service Meeting until the next gathering. These committees were: Policy, Finance, Agenda-Admissions and Literature-Publishing.

—John L. Norris, Chairman
General Service Board

VOTING: HOW IT WORKS

Following a question from the floor regarding the method of determining a two-thirds majority during the election of trustees, delegates voted to continue using the present mathematical formula in determining the percentage of total vote in elections of trustees (rounding to nearest whole — .5 and over to larger figure; below .5 to lower figure).

Nominating

Since the 1970 General Service Conference, the Trustees' Nominating Committee reviewed and recommended to the General Service Board:

1. That the following slate of officers and directors of the Grapevine Corporate Board be elected by that Board.

Ruth W. — president & chairman
Paula C. — vice president & sec.
George G. — treasurer

Directors

Austin MacCormick
Milton Maxwell, Ph.D.
Jack M.
Robert P.
Ralph A.

2. That Charles E. and Peter S. be elected directors of the Grapevine Corporate Board.
3. That Milton Maxwell, submitted by the Grapevine Corporate Board, be elected president and chairman of that Board.
4. That Ralph A., submitted by the Grapevine Corporate Board, be elected Class B general service trustee. Milton Maxwell, and Dr. John Bealer be elected Class A trustees at the annual meeting of the members of the General Service Board, following their presentation to the 1971 General Service Conference for disapproval, if any.
5. Austin MacCormick, Class A trustee, be elected first vice chairman and Midge M., staff coordinator, be elected assistant secretary of the General Service Board.
6. That the following slate of trustee candidates be presented for election at the annual meeting of the members of the General Service Board in April, following presentation to the 1971 General Service Conference for disapproval, if any:

CLASS A

John Bealer, M.D.
Travis Dancy, M.D.
Vincent Dole, M.D.
Austin MacCormick
Milton Maxwell, Ph.D.
Arthur Miles
John L. Norris, M.D.

CLASS B

William C.
Donald F.
James H.
Stephen O.
Robert P.
Bayard P. (through 1971)
John R.

- 6a. The following additional Class B trustee vacancies have been filled, as indicated below:

Ralph A., G.S. trustee
Don A., Southwest region
Tom G., trustee at large, Canada
George G., Pacific region
Jack M., East Central region
Tom M., Southeast region
Robert R., Eastern Canada region

7. That the following slate of officers, presented by the General Service Board, be elected at the annual meeting of the members in April, 1971:

John L. Norris, M.D.	chairman
Austin MacCormick	1st vice chairman
Donald F.	2nd vice chairman
John R.	secretary
Arthur Miles	treasurer
Midge M.	assistant secretary
Dennis Manders	assistant treasurer

8. That the following director candidates of A.A. World Services, Inc. be elected at the annual meeting of the members of A.A.W.S., Inc., in April:

Robert H.	Stephen O., Sr.
Robert M.	Bayard P.
Midge M.	Robert P.

Walter M.

9. That the following slate of officers of A.A. World Services, Inc., be elected at their meeting in May, 1971:

Robert H.	president
Bayard P.	first vice president
Midge M.	second vice president
Stephen O., Sr.	treasurer
Ann M.	secretary (non-voting)

Finally, it was the privilege of the members of the Trustees' Nominating Committee to review the resumes of 50 regional Class B trustee candidates from five regions (East Central, Southeast, Pacific, Southwest, and Eastern Canada), and 8 resumes of general service Class B trustee-at-large candidates from Canada.

We are delighted to say that all candidates (40 regionals and 8 at-large) were found eligible for consideration.

Reviewed a "Proposal for Change in Election Procedure of Regional Trustee," signed by eight delegates from the Pacific region and referred the proposal to the Conference Committee on Trustees, with the recommendation that the proposal is not in the best interest of A.A. at this time. —*Robert P., chairman Trustees' Nominating Committee*

Trustees' Meetings

The Board of Trustees will meet during the coming year on the following dates: August 2, November 1, 1971, January 31 and April 22, 1972.

NEW TRUSTEES ELECTED

(See biographies, page 45)

Nonalcoholic

John D. Bealer, M.D., Bethlehem, Pennsylvania
Milton A. Maxwell, Ph.D., New Brunswick, N. J.

Alcoholic

Ralph A., general service trustee, New York
Donald A., Southwest region
Thomas G., trustee at large, Canada
George G., Pacific region
Jack M., East Central region
Thomas M., Southeast region
Robert R., Eastern Canada

CONFERENCE COMMITTEE CHAIRMEN

A new feature of the 1971 Conference was a brief presentation given by Conference Committee chairmen during which they described the activities of their particular committees to fellow delegates who then had an opportunity to ask questions and make suggestions. The Conference committees, all headed by delegates, are: Agenda/Admissions; Conference Report and Charter; Finance; Grapevine; Institutions; Literature; Public Information; Policy, and Trustees. A new committee on relations with outside agencies was added this year. At the same time, the tour of G.S.O. and Grapevine offices was held later in the week rather than on the first day of the Conference as in previous years.

A.A. IS WHERE YOU FIND IT

A conference of church women was also held at the New Yorker during the General Service Conference and there was considerable confusion for a time as to who met where. A very young couple who were obviously newlyweds or part of the church get-together wandered down one morning and were stopped at the door. "Sorry," they were told "the church meeting is upstairs, this is an A.A. Conference." The young man grinned. "Then, I'm among friends," he said. He was an A.A. member from Kitchener, Ontario, accompanying his wife to the big town for her church meeting. The ticket broker in the lobby was also a member.

Delegate's Report to Area-I

Knowing that I could count on the full support of my committee I was able to prearrange a schedule of visitations throughout the state for the reports. In this manner, a time-consuming and sometimes worrisome detail was eliminated. At the same time I requested that the term "sharing session" be employed and that time be allotted for a question and answer period. In this way I hoped to lure in a few of the "unwary" who refer to delegates' reports as "A.A. politics."

On my return from the 1970 conference I was convinced that the thrust of the sharing sessions must be to acquaint the fellowship not only with the business we transacted but with the conference itself — that I must do everything in my power to take the Oregon membership with me on this unforgettable journey. I hoped to plant the seed and nurture a feeling of oneness, of unanimity of spirit, between my area's A.A. and the staff, the trustees, the delegates; to create in their minds the true image of the combined Conference. . .one composed of dedicated men and women, alcoholic and nonalcoholic, who are working together for our common cause.

A great boon in giving the report is the looseleaf binder which contains all the information pertaining to the Conference. I would have been lost without it. Together with marginal notes, it brought to mind many half-forgotten thoughts and ideas as well as the memory of the beautiful people who so willingly shared with me.

—Betty V.

Delegate's Report to Area-II

In giving the delegate's report to area meetings I tried to inform members first of what a delegate's duties are, how he is filled in on the actions of previous Conferences and advised of what to expect. Then I described the make-up of the Conference, stressing the fact that area delegates carry the heavy influence which is felt in two ways: they make up Conference Committees, covering just about all kinds of A.A. activities, and all delegates have free access to the Conference platform for discussion of all actions affecting the movement.

Following this, I described the visit to the G.S. office and gave highlights from various talks, including Eric B.'s keynote speech and Bernard Smith's description of the early history and development of the General Service Conference, as well as his description of why it is needed. Then I gave brief outlines of major reports by trustees and staff as well as observations regarding the future of A.A. — that A.A. can never become so set in its ways that we cannot search for new ways to extend the hand of fellowship to alcoholics wherever they may be. We must be flexible without becoming so loose that our methods and our message get watered down. We must maintain stability without becoming so rigid that we cannot bend to meet the changing needs of still-suffering alcoholics.

A delegate's effectiveness depends on how well he is able to transmit the world picture to his committee members and how well he can inspire them to pass on this information and his own enthusiasm to G.S.R.'s, groups and central offices and intergroups.

—John M.

Delegates Host Delegates

A very informal and successful get-acquainted meeting for delegates was held on Sunday afternoon, April 18, at the Hotel New Yorker.

Panel 20 played host to the incoming Panel 21 delegates. Many of these present had come in the night before, but the Sunday arrivals lost no time in finding the Panel Room, where the get-acquainted meeting was held. One delegate even arrived with his luggage still in tow. Coffee, tea, soft drinks and cake were served. The delegates also picked up their badges so everyone was on a first-name basis in no time.

The chairman, Margaret C., after extending a warm welcome to all, asked for a moment of silence in memory of Bill and then turned the meeting over to Betty H., the delegate from Arizona. Betty called upon many delegates from both panels to capsule their A.A. stories into three minutes. The time limit, for the most part, was adhered to and the afternoon was filled with many amusing and touching stories.

Later some of the trustees joined the gathering and some of them also gave their A.A. stories. Dr. Norris was particularly moving, expressing his thanks to the delegates for their kind messages he had received from them after Mrs. Norris' death.

There seemed to be no question in the minds of all who attended that this get-acquainted meeting was very worthwhile and should become a part of the Conference. It was heartwarming to see the members of Panel 20 taking the Panel 21 delegates under their wings and it was obvious that a good A.A. meeting was enjoyed by all — as it always is.

NEW MEETING PLACE FOR 1972 CONFERENCE

On the basis of action taken at the Delegates' Only meeting that the 1972 Conference be held at another hotel, negotiations have been completed with the Hotel Roosevelt and we will return there next year.

SHORT FORM OF THE TWELVE CONCEPTS

The 1971 General Service Conference approved the short form of the Twelve Concepts. They will be available from G.S.O.

THE RETIRING TRUSTEES

This has been a great Conference — a source of never-ending excitement and joy to see the group conscience at work. I know of no other place where people of widely different backgrounds can bring widely differing points of view together and come out of it with substantial agreement. And never have we seen anyone so determined to have their own way that personalities come to dominate and destroy the good feelings and unity of the Fellowship. I pray God that they never shall.

Very little has been said about our fundamental obligation to protect everyone else's anonymity. If we break our own anonymity at the personal level, it is only to modify, break down to any extent the stigma which causes our society to reject people who are still in trouble with alcohol. At the same time, however, we must accept the obligation to protect others' anonymity both inside and outside the Fellowship. If we want to break our own anonymity, that is our privilege except at the public level. But it is no one else's privilege. And as we talk among ourselves we must be sure that we hurt no one else.

John L. Norris, M.D., chairman, G.S.B.

'A Mountain-Top Experience'

This has been a mountain-top experience and it is now that our work really begins. We must go back to our areas and pass on what we have learned here — communicate the spirit of a vital and unified Alcoholics Anonymous. Every peak is surrounded by a valley. And as we come off this one, let us know that God doesn't only talk to us when we're at the top of the mountain. He reaches out to us in many ways and at many times in the valley of ordinary days. Let us remind ourselves that a great part of the message that we carry is in what we are. I pray that you and I will be given the courage and real desire to always communicate with love.

Margaret C., chairman, Area Delegates

'Trying to Pay Back'

Serving on the Board is similar to doing any other job in A.A. You try to pay back what you owe and find that you're just that much further in debt at the end of your term. I don't think that there will ever be a time when I can put back into A.A. what A.A. has given me.

I think, too, that most of us always feel that the period in which we served was best. I feel this way, too. We had the first World Conference and the International Convention at Miami Beach. I remember telling someone that there will

never be a nicer one — because I was part of it. And I am so grateful for having had the opportunity to serve.

But what do we do now? As long as there is an A.A. there will be something for me to do. I know this. A week ago I was out in my little shop with our duplicator and I was running off copies of the agenda for our state conference. If I had stayed home long enough, I would have helped address and stuff the envelopes. So you can see there is still something for me to do in A.A., and I look forward to it.

Andy A., retiring trustee, East Central Region

'A Rewarding Experience'

I feel somewhat sad about going off the Board because it has been a very rich and rewarding experience. Yet, I think that four years is long enough for a trustee to serve. And I don't believe that we go back to wherever we were before, after having served as a delegate or trustee. We have the added experience we have gained in service work, and thus have even more to give. So I am really looking forward to having a little bit more to give in extending the hand of A.A. and keeping it warm and strong and vital.

My mind goes back four years to when I was elected. I went to the mirror and gave myself what I call the eye test, as I wondered if I was big enough to be a trustee. I wondered if I was smart enough. Then I recalled the story of the little boy who prayed at Thanksgiving Dinner, "Dear God, please stretch me." It's a silly little story, but that became my prayer, "Dear God, please stretch me — please make me into the type of person that can serve on the Board of Trustees."

I came to New York as the only woman regional trustee, and found that I was accepted, that there were no regional differences. I had an opportunity to get acquainted with the A.A.W.S. and Grapevine directors and staff, as well as five panels of delegates, and I can certainly tell you that the Conference is truly the voice of A.A. Thank you all.

Katharine P., retiring trustee, Southwest Region

'Learning in A.A.'

I have been engaged in business here in New York for forty years, and I've learned more in the last four years as a trustee of A.A. than I learned in the preceding thirty-six. In business we have bosses. In A.A. we have only servants. It seems to me that we need to be servants, because in order to progress, we have to learn and receive. I think that most of us tried to progress by ourselves, and found that we couldn't. We needed power from the outside.

MAKE FAREWELL TALKS

Bossing blunts one's ability to receive, because one is putting out most of the time, and therefore there isn't much time to take in. And bossing also assumes life or death responsibility over other people — a responsibility that in A.A. must be left with the individual.

So in A.A., we have a common goal, an application of common principles, the existence of common penalties and rewards and finally a lack of competition and the fact that we all gain what one gains. It creates in A.A. that incredible paradox of autonomy on the one hand, and unity under our Higher Power on the other. This is what I've learned in these last four years, and I thank you all from the bottom of my heart for giving me the chance to learn it.

*Bayard P., retiring (12/71)
G.S. trustee*

'Importance of the Minority'

I think that the message I take from so many of these Conferences is in regard to the importance of the minority voice. Sometimes we have the right to be wrong, but we also have the right to be right and fight for what we believe in. Yesterday, the whole Conference seemed to be going a certain way, and two voices said, "wait a minute." As a result, we took another look and found that we weren't thinking too clearly on that particular point. And this is the way it is in A.A.

The longer we are in service, the greater our realization of how marvelous A.A. is, and how great is our personal responsibility. As it says in the Bible, "To whom much is given, much is required," and this is true for any of us who have been delegates or trustees or served in any way. The thought just came to me, "They also serve who only stand and wait." And for me maybe the message is that when I go back as an ex-trustee, I will stand and wait. If somebody needs me, I'll be there.

Eric B., retiring trustee, Pacific Region

'Accepting What We Can Give'

One of the most difficult things I had to learn in my growing up years in sobriety was to accept the fact that I had something to give, and you have helped me during the past four years to recognize that it is not the extent of my talents that matter, but that I use them in the best way that I can and in whatever direction they are pointed.

In these past years I think most of all that you have made me realize that mine is a commitment to life. I have been undergoing a personal problem, and there were times when I felt that I did not have the strength or the will to cope. Yet it was

in this period of service that I fully realized how strong is my commitment to life — to its responsibilities, its joys and its pains. And for this, I am eternally grateful to all of you. I am happy, not because I am leaving, but because I am leaving with so much. You have helped me to be able to say, yes, I am a full-grown, sober alcoholic with something to offer. And it is all right to say so. Thank you so very much.

Ruth W., retiring G.S. trustee

'The Right to Be Wrong'

The Board provided me with the right to be wrong regularly. You never realize how wrong you can be sometimes. But they're kind. They don't stomp on you as we do at regular meetings. They don't start a new Board. They talk to you afterwards.

In 1964, I visited the office in New York and met Bill and the staff members, and I was quite convinced that my life in A.A. had been fulfilled. Then, I was elected delegate on Panel 15 and met all of the other delegates from all parts of the country. It was then I got to feel the bigness of what A.A. is. Then I got on the Board and I wondered what I was doing there. And I'll tell you the same thing I told them four years ago; that I came out of the bottle to become a member of Alcoholics Anonymous, and out of the hat to become a trustee. And it has had some sort of a sobering influence. My heart is full and I am grateful to all of you for what you have given me.

Maurice R., retiring trustee, Southeast Region

HOSPITALITY COMMITTEE

Again in 1971 the hospitality committee provided delegates' wives with an opportunity to get acquainted with each other and with the city during the week-long Conference. A hospitality suite was maintained where visitors were welcome to chat with local A.A. members and each other. At the same time they were provided with a trip to the Cloisters, tour of the Good Housekeeping Institute, fashion and decorating shows, visits to N.Y.C. Intergroup and Al-Anon headquarters, sightseeing and other entertainment.

Most wives, many of whom were visiting New York for the first or second time found the advice and direction given by hospitality committee members just what was needed to make their stay in the city enjoyable.

CONFERENCE COMMITTEE REPORTS

Agenda/Admissions

The Conference Committee on Agenda/Admissions recommended:

1. That the Agenda/Admissions Committee remain Agenda/Admissions; that the "Admissions" part of this Committee *not* become a part of the Committee on Conference Policy, as suggested by a former delegate.
2. That the A.A. meeting on Monday night be retained and that the G.S.O. staff be presented for short A.A. talks every other year, with a delegate chairman. That there be two delegate speakers with a delegate chairman on alternate years. This format to be reviewed every year by Agenda/Admissions Committee.
3. That the same format be used for Workshops for next year's Conference and the number of Workshops be a minimum of two; more if possible.
4. That specific time be allotted to all speakers, and the "bell" be rung, no matter who is speaking; presentation be kept in brief form; nothing vital be scheduled after a presentation or session which may become controversial, gripe sessions be held between 3-5 p.m. when they can run into the evening session and not interfere with an important session; priorities be established as to which subjects are best for the groups as a whole; and Agenda/Admission members send in opinions as to what modifications on present agenda should be made for next year's agenda, prior to November 1, 1971.
5. That in view of the heavy agenda this year and the apparent problem in completing it on time, it has been suggested that some item (possibly of lower priority) be shown as "optional" subjects. These should be so placed on the agenda, that if we run out of time on earlier subjects, the "optional" items could be eliminated for that specific year.
6. That it is the primary responsibility of the duly elected delegates to see that the heretofore agreed-upon contribution of \$150.00 towards Conference expenses be paid by March 1. If not received by March 1, a letter be sent directly to the delegate, pointing out that unless this area shares in the expenses of the Conference, said delegate will be referred to the Agenda/Admissions Committee for discussion.
7. Limiting the size of the Conference was referred to the Long-Range Planning Committee by the Agenda/Admission Committee in 1970 for their consideration. That committee recommended that the Conference should not be much larger than it is now; that its make-up should remain proportionately similar to its present structure; that the number of non-delegate members should not exceed 1/3 of the total Conference membership. Therefore, the 2-year Moratorium on applications by areas for additional delegate representation, which was approved by the 19th Conference, be terminated, and detailed questionnaires be prepared for areas seeking additional representation and to be sent to

each area every two years for a re-evaluation of the Conference area structure.

8. That where a delegate does not have his own assembly, he look forward to establishing one.

Elected Richard H., Northern Indiana, as new chairman.

Finance

The Conference Committee on Finance recommended:

1. Confirmation of the General Service Board's authorization to The A.A.W.A. Board of Directors to increase the prices on books and literature if and when necessary — to be reviewed by the Conference Finance Committee two years from now.
2. That the \$3.00 per-year, per-member yardstick remain as is, and a concentrated effort to involve more groups be undertaken.
3. That the Agenda/Admissions Committee arrange to have extensive sharing sessions on the matter of increasing contributions and finances on the 1972 Conference agenda.
4. That the delegates obtain the thinking of their areas on the uses of the Bill W. Memorial Fund and communicate their findings to the trustees for guidance.

Elected John N., Colorado, as new Chairman.

Conference Policy

The Committee on Conference Policy recommended:

1. That Ask-It-Basket be continued in its present form and, to avoid confusion, none of the answer sessions be held during meal time.
2. That the Committee on Conference Policy will take over the function of the Conference evaluation handled last year by the Task Force; that a questionnaire will be mailed by the committee members to Panel 20 and 21 delegates within six weeks from the conclusion of this Conference; that this questionnaire be returned to the committee members who will summarize the replies and send this summarization with the originals to the chairman for tabulation. These recommendations will be forwarded by the chairman to the committee secretary.
3. That there is no need for a Conference Committee on Traditions at this time.

APPROVED BY DELEGATES

4. That it is not necessary to write to new delegates asking them if they are willing to serve on the committee to which they have been chosen, but rather in the interest of expediency they will be informed of their committee assignment.
5. That rather than accept the Oklahoma Plan as written the Conference adopt unstructured open workshops with no specific subjects on the agenda and that these unstructured workshops be summarized and reported to the Conference.
6. That the Conference accept the Task Force decisions as written in Dr. Jack's letter of December, 1970, with our appreciation and thanks for the time, effort and energy expended by this Task Force.
7. That we accept the recommendation from the Conference Committee on Public Information for the formation of a Conference Committee on Professional Relations to correspond with the Trustees' Committee on Professional Relations; that five delegates from Panel 22 be drawn by lot for the Conference Committee on Professional Relations, that four members from Panel 23 will be added to the committee to bring it up to its full complement of nine. The Conference will then have ten Conference Committees comprised of nine members each at the present Conference size.
8. That agendas for all Conference Committees be mailed to all delegates before the Conference.

Elected Neal M., S.E. Texas, as new chairman.

Literature

The Conference Committee on Literature recommended:

1. That the "illustrated" format used for the Traditions pamphlet be considered for use in future A.A. literature.
2. That the "A.A. and Armed Services" pamphlet now in preparation be directed toward the alcoholic in the armed services rather than the higher echelon, and that A.A. stories of armed services experiences be forwarded to the committee secretary.
3. That Box 4-5-9 be included on the price list of the regular literature order blank, if G.S.O. finds this suggestion feasible.
4. That the suggestion of placing the Big Book and pamphlets in public, school, university and church libraries has worked well in many areas and that all delegates consider this as a project for their area committees.
5. That the delegates assume responsibility for informing A.A.'s of all available Conference-approved literature and that the updated spring and fall literature order blanks which are

mailed with Box 4-5-9 be reviewed at district and assembly meetings.

6. That the Literature Committee following the general feeling of the Conference, reaffirm both the spirit and the wording of the "I Am Responsible" declaration from the International Convention held in Toronto in 1965.

Reported that two new pamphlets are in the process of preparation, "Came to Believe" and "How We Stay Sober." They will be working on these during the coming year.

Expressed a unanimous vote of thanks to the professional writers assigned by G.S.O. to work on literature for the excellent job they have done and to the members of the Trustees' Literature Committee for their sharing and assistance during the joint meeting held prior to this meeting and throughout the year.

Elected John R., Southeastern New York, as new chairman.

Public Information

The Conference Committee on Public Information recommended:

1. That the Survey proposed by the Trustees' P.I. Committee be undertaken.
2. Approved the Anonymity Statement presented by the Trustees' P.I. Committee with the following reservation:
 - a) that it be made clear that disclosing one's A.A. membership to those outside A.A. be a matter of personal choice and not a matter of obligation. With this in mind, the committee suggests the revision of certain paragraphs and wishes to see the revised draft before it is put into circulation.
3. That the Wallet Card Anonymity Statement (suggested by the 1970 Conference) be accepted, and suggested that the term "self-aggrandizement" be eliminated in favor of a simpler and more easily pronounced word.
4. That the "Student's Guide to Alcoholics Anonymous" (suggested by the 1970 Conference) be accepted for publication with minor revisions.
5. Reviewed the contents of the P.I. Kit, and recommended that the Trustees' Committee consider combining and compressing existing material in the form of a P.I. Manual.
6. That other areas explore the possibility of using "What Happened to Joe" as a comic strip in local newspapers as reported by an A.A. member in the February P.I. Bulletin.

Elected Hal M., Washington, D.C., as new chairman.

Grapevine

The Conference Grapevine Committee recommended:

1. That the Grapevine Corporate Board be given Conference approval to raise the price of the Grapevine from 35¢ to 50¢ for a single copy, and from \$3.50 to \$5.00 for a yearly subscription, if the trend of rising costs indicates that the need is there.
2. That all delegates return to their home groups with a determination to begin thinking of the Grapevine as a major tool in helping to achieve and maintain sobriety.

Elected Bob A., Hawaii, as new chairman.

Institutions

The Conference Committee on Institutions recommended:

1. That in a discussion of separating the Hospital and Prison Service into subcommittees of the present Institutions Committee it was the sense of the meeting that the Institutions Committee remain the same.
2. That the delegates give wholehearted support to the efforts of the General Service Office to establish an Institutions Correspondence Service on an individual basis, similar to the Loner-Sponsor Service.
3. That each delegate study the possibility of receiving the necessary quantity of Institutions Bulletins for his area.
4. That the General Service Board participate more directly with the Institutions Conference Committee.

Elected Bob B., Western Pennsylvania, as new chairman

Report and Charter

The Committee of the Conference Report and Charter recommended:

1. That the summary of the Ask-It-Basket Questions and Answers in its present form is an important and valuable reference aid and suggested the following to make this material even more useful:
 - a. date the current summary and date each additional entry hereafter, and provide a cover index for easier research.
 - b. suggest this material be made available to the general Fellowship, perhaps in the form of a handbook, as a salable item to all groups, with particular attention given to G.S.R. and committee member distribution.
2. That the Advisory Actions summary be retained in its present loose-leaf form, but with the addition of a cover index and updated each year.

3. Approved of and recommended adoption of a rewording of paragraph two of article 5 of the Conference Charter (as it was referred to it by the Agenda/Admissions Committee), paragraph two to read: "Generally speaking, each state and province will be entitled to one assembly. However, more than one state or province may be joined to another state or province to form one assembly area. But states and provinces of large A.A. populations and/or whose geography presents communications problems may be entitled to additional assemblies, as provided by the A.A. Service Manual, or by any further amendment thereto."
4. That next year's Conference issue of *Box 4-5-9* carry a digest of the agenda, and that, should "In Memoriam" listing be carried, these be confined to past and present trustees and current delegates.
5. That G.S.O. discuss whether or not central offices or Inter-groups should be included as a separate chapter in the next updating of the A.A. Service Manual.

Elected Bill V., B.C./Yukon area, as new chairman.

Trustees

The Conference Committee on Trustees recommended:

1. That the words "but not mandatory" be deleted from the description of the A.A. Regional Trustee and from the Composition, Scope and Procedure of the Trustees' Nominating Committee after the words "ten years of continued sobriety is desirable."
2. That a recommendation received from the Trustees' Nominating Committee be accepted as follows: "that the proposed change in election procedures of Regional Trustees which suggested that the members of the Conference Committee on Trustees be omitted from the listing of voting members, is not in the best interest of A.A. at this time."
3. That the slate of members and officers of the General Service Board for the period of April, 1971 through April, 1972, be accepted.
4. That Ralph A., Milton Maxwell, and Dr. John Bealer be approved for election at the 1971 Annual Meeting of the Members of the General Service Board.
5. That when electoral procedures require an alternate to sit in for an area delegate whose region is electing a trustee, because he is also serving on the Conference Committee on Trustees, that no voting instructions be given to the alternate.
6. That the area delegate assume the responsibility for sending trustee-candidate resumes to G.S.O.
7. That state of health be included in trustee nominee resumes.

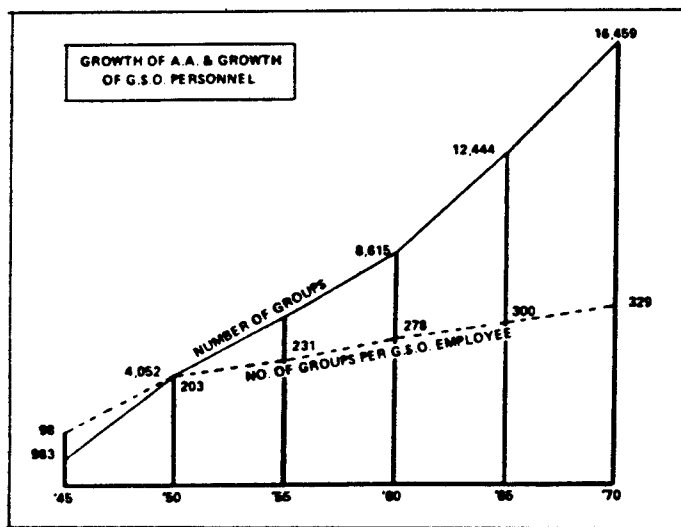
Elected Joseph B., Southern Wisconsin, as new chairman.

Growth & Money at G.S.O.

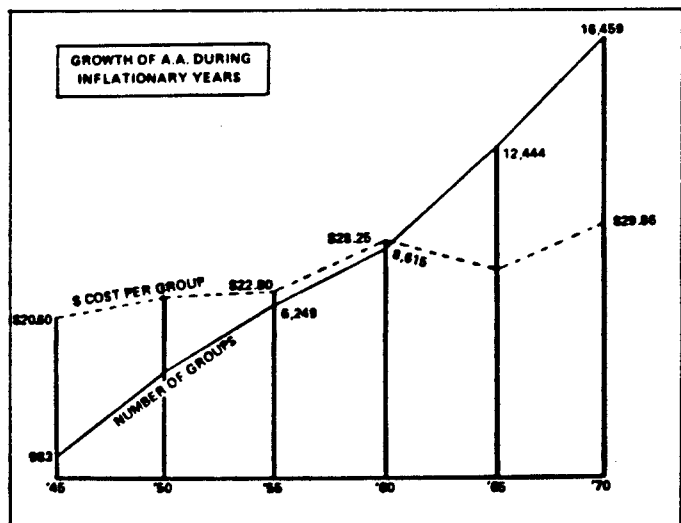
How efficient has been G.S.O.'s growth? In terms of personnel – in 1945 there was one employee for each 98 groups. Today, one employee serves each 329 groups.

During the past twenty five years, the G.S.O. budget has increased from \$20,000 to \$513,800 for services charged to the group contribution account. During that same period, cost of living increased 119%. Adjusting for this change in dollar value, we find that the cost of services per group actually showed a decrease from \$20.60 to \$14.24.

	Groups	Employees	Groups per Employee	\$ Cost per Group	Living Cost
1945	983	10	98	\$20.60	100
1950	4,052	20	202	22.06	139
1955	6,249	27	230	22.81	148
1960	8,615	31	278	28.25	165
1970	16,459	50	329	29.86	219



1. (Above) There are more than 16 times as many groups today as in 1945. The number of services has increased greatly, too, in the same period. Today, however, there are 329 groups for each G.S.O. employee, compared with only 98 in 1945.



2. (Above) During the years 1945 through 1970, the cost of living increased 119 percent. Constant striving for increased efficiency succeeded in keeping G.S.O. service cost per group to \$29.86 in 1970 compared with \$20.60 in 1945, an increase of only 45 percent.

1971 G.S.O. Budget

The budget for 1971 Operations of G.S.O. activities – Exclusive of the A.A. Grapevine – is as follows:

BUDGET

A.A. WORLD SERVICES, INC.—PUBLISHING

INCOME

Sales	\$565,300*
Less: Cost of Products	232,700
Gross Profit from Sales	332,600

TOTAL EXPENSES

Excess of Income (Expense)	79,700
----------------------------	--------

*Based upon the sale of:

- 58,500 Books – “Alcoholics Anonymous”
- 22,500 Books – “12 Steps & 12 Traditions” (Reg.)
- 7,200 Books – “12 Steps & 12 Traditions” (Pocket)
- 7,000 Books – “A.A. Comes of Age”
- 12,000 Books – “As Bill Sees It”
- Pamphlets & Miscellaneous Items

OFFICE EXPENSES – GROUP SERVICES

INCOME

Contributions	\$465,000
---------------	-----------

TOTAL EXPENSES

Excess of Income (Expense)	(48,800)
----------------------------	----------

**Includes cost of General Service Conference – \$ 31,300

GENERAL FUND—TRUSTEES' EXPENSES

INCOME

\$ –0–

TOTAL EXPENSES

41,400***

Excess of Income (Expense)

(41,400)

***Board Meetings, P.J.C. Expense, Special Projects.

The Publishing activity will contribute \$79,700 to the budgeted deficits.

1971 Grapevine Budget

Estimated income from subscription and other sales.....	\$255,000
Estimated Expense.....	254,300

Net income from operations.....	700
Interest from Savings accounts.....	8,000

Net income.....	8,700
-----------------	-------

1970 Group Contributions

U.S.	# Gps. re- ported	# Gps. Contrib.	% of Gps. Contrib.	# Gps. R.C.P.	% of Gps. on R.C.P.	Amount of Contrib.	Member- ship	Contrib's. per Capita
Alabama	79	47	59.6%	12	25.5%	\$ 2,694.70	1,118	\$ 2.41
Alaska	41	19	46.3	7	36.8	1,447.80	347	4.17
Arizona	146	86	58.9	25	29.1	4,650.71	1,650	2.82
Arkansas	83	53	63.9	14	26.4	2,890.05	1,030	2.80
California	1,389	802	57.7	329	41.0	49,046.03	32,394	1.52
Colorado	141	70	49.7	31	44.2	4,179.35	1,939	2.15
Connecticut	226	130	57.6	38	29.2	9,192.20	3,571	2.57
Delaware	33	25	75.6	11	45.0	1,795.00	489	3.67
Dist. of Columbia	56	39	69.7	19	48.7	4,519.50	1,415	3.19
Florida	331	209	63.1	73	34.9	22,144.40	5,062	4.37
Georgia	176	116	65.9	42	36.2	5,072.16	2,538	2.00
Hawaii	37	19	51.5	5	26.3	722.50	478	1.51
Idaho	43	23	53.6	6	26.0	810.00	440	1.84
Illinois	686	527	76.8	52	9.8	13,843.56	13,900	1.00
Indiana	208	143	68.8	43	30.0	8,285.40	3,057	2.71
Iowa	128	73	57.1	20	27.4	4,492.44	2,403	1.86
Kansas	122	89	72.9	15	16.8	4,170.51	2,227	1.87
Kentucky	124	72	58.0	14	19.4	7,199.35	1,563	4.60
Louisiana	92	58	63.0	16	27.5	3,022.13	1,681	1.79
Maine	48	42	87.6	9	21.4	1,635.50	570	2.86
Maryland	171	118	69.0	37	31.3	7,020.91	2,536	2.77
Massachusetts	290	160	55.1	61	38.1	10,796.62	6,005	1.80
Michigan	382	228	59.6	79	34.6	19,071.29	6,014	3.17
Minnesota	264	180	68.2	33	18.3	9,006.43	6,000	1.50
Mississippi	53	33	62.2	9	27.3	1,372.75	751	1.83
Missouri	199	116	58.3	39	33.6	7,213.98	2,837	2.54
Montana	61	38	62.2	8	21.7	1,588.74	658	2.41
Nebraska	84	49	58.3	12	24.6	2,726.70	985	2.77
Nevada	57	38	66.7	16	44.4	2,245.50	998	2.25
New Hampshire	38	26	68.4	9	34.6	1,645.49	633	2.60
New Jersey	276	201	72.9	76	37.8	15,265.67	4,215	3.62
New Mexico	73	44	60.3	10	22.7	2,266.25	1,077	2.10
New York	646	420	65.0	168	40.0	36,120.83	12,601	2.87
North Carolina	180	120	66.6	35	29.1	7,621.05	2,695	2.83
North Dakota	45	20	44.5	3	15.0	1,096.00	529	2.07
Ohio	498	298	59.9	67	22.5	16,360.36	9,726	1.68
Oklahoma	110	87	79.0	40	45.9	4,540.04	1,619	2.80
Oregon	115	68	59.1	18	26.4	4,026.12	1,194	3.37
Pennsylvania	330	237	71.8	68	28.6	17,990.03	5,314	3.39
Rhode Island	36	28	77.8	11	39.2	2,389.87	448	5.33
South Carolina	79	49	62.0	8	16.3	2,835.95	1,187	2.39
South Dakota	47	27	57.4	2	7.4	1,112.60	761	1.46
Tennessee	86	60	69.7	8	13.3	3,265.76	1,349	2.42
Texas	390	256	65.6	84	32.8	17,640.44	8,236	2.14
Utah	56	33	58.9	13	39.3	1,276.38	742	1.72
Vermont	32	24	76.0	5	20.8	1,828.88	392	4.66
Virginia	161	119	73.9	42	35.2	7,839.43	2,580	3.04
Washington	217	155	71.4	56	36.1	10,856.30	2,553	4.25
West Virginia	61	43	70.5	10	23.2	3,097.17	660	4.69
Wisconsin	252	162	64.3	26	16.1	6,661.81	2,966	2.25
Wyoming	26	16	61.6	1	6.3	607.00	302	2.01
Commonwealth of P.R.	33	28	84.8	5	17.8	1,316.31	641	2.05
Canal Zone	2	2	100.0	1	50.0	400.00	49	8.16
Bahama Islands	2	2	100.0	1	50.0	35.00	42	.83
Virgin Islands of U.S.	2	2	100.0	1	50.0	45.00	32	1.41
Total for U.S.	9,541	6,129	64.2%	1,843	30.1%	\$380,995.95	167,167	\$ 2.28

CANADA	# Gps. re- ported	# Gps. Contrib.	% of Gps. Contrib.	# Gps. R.C.P.	% of Gps. on R.C.P.	Amount of Contrib.	Member- ship	Contrib's. per Capita
Alberta	148	78	52.7%	8	10.2%	\$ 3,614.93	1,343	\$ 2.69
Atlantic Prov.								
New Brunswick	55	29	52.7	4	13.7	1,062.15	712	1.49
Newfoundland	20	10	50.	3	30.0	437.26	224	1.95
Nova Scotia	59	38	64.4	5	13.2	1,874.52	693	2.70
Prince Ed. Is.	21	9	42.9	1	11.1	310.46	307	1.01
British Columbia	217	124	57.1	14	11.3	6,111.90	2,654	2.30
Manitoba	83	39	47.0	6	15.3	2,358.02	1,581	1.49
N.W. Territories	5	3	60.0	1	33.3	75.40	31	2.43
Ontario	490	286	58.4	81	28.3	20,839.58	7,168	2.91
Quebec	419	257	61.3	83	32.2	7,280.44	9,536	.76
Saskatchewan	148	83	56.1	3	36.2	3,457.82	1,688	2.05
Yukon Terr.	2	2	100.0	0	0 -	12.00	20	.60

TOTAL for CANADA 1,667 958 57.5% 209 21.8% \$ 47,434.48 25,957 \$ 1.83

TOTAL for CANADA 11,208 7,087 63.2% 2,052 28.9% \$428,430.43 193,124 \$ 2.22

FOREIGN & OTHER

Foreign						3,350.31		
World Hello						50.53		
International Doctors						218.00		
Hospital Groups						1,783.78		
Prison Groups						192.93		
Internationalists						677.77		
Young People in A.A.						300.00		
International Deaf						3.00		
GRAND TOTAL						\$435,006.75		

GROUP CONTRIBUTION COMPARISON — 1970 — 1969

	# Gps. re- ported	# Gps. Contrib.	% of Gps. Contrib.	# Gps. R.C.P.	% of Gps. on R.C.P.	Amount of Contrib.	Member- ship	Contrib's. per Capita
U.S.A. 1970	9,541	6,129	64.2%	1,843	30.1%	\$380,995.95	167,167	\$ 2.28
U.S.A. 1969	9,047	5,765	63.7	1,458	25.3	348,196.68	156,817	2.22
Increase (Decrease)	494	364	0.5%	385	4.8%	\$ 32,799.27	10,350	\$.06
Canada 1970	1,667	958	57.5%	209	21.8%	\$ 47,434.48	25,957	\$ 1.83
Canada 1969	1,590	875	55.0	128	14.6	44,414.18	22,661	1.96
Increase (Decrease)	77	83	2.5%	81	7.2%	\$ 3,020.30	3,296	\$ (.13)
U.S. & Canada 1970	11,208	7,087	63.2%	2,052	28.9%	\$428,430.43	193,124	\$ 2.22
U.S. & Canada 1969	10,637	6,640	62.4	1,586	23.9	392,610.86	179,478	2.19
Increase (Decrease)	571	447	0.8%	466	5.0%	\$ 35,819.57	13,646	\$.03

INCOME STATEMENT

The General Service Office

YEAR ENDED DECEMBER 31, 1970

	<u>1970</u>	<u>1969</u>
INCOME		
Net Sales, after Book Discounts waived of \$40,949 in 1970 and \$36,435 in 1969	\$524,775	\$472,727
Less: Cost of Printing	157,138	133,944
Royalties	58,307	51,934
Gross Profit from Literature	309,330	286,849
Contributions – A.A. Groups and Members	434,633	397,146
35th Anniversary Convention	15,809	–
Total Income	<u>\$759,772</u>	<u>\$683,995</u>
EXPENSES		
Salaries	\$404,520	\$349,635
Rent	49,966	34,324
Office relocation costs	134,626	15,000
Exchange Bulletin	17,656	15,587
World Directory	25,455	21,820
Other Service Office Printing	14,455	14,149
Shipping and Mailing	61,525	52,987
Other Office Expenses	74,835	50,293
Insurance and Taxes	30,335	28,378
Professional Services	11,800	10,792
Board, Committee, Staff Meetings	13,302	11,850
Writing, Research, Bedford Hills	8,886	7,717
P.I.C., Travel	7,847	9,361
General Service Conference	33,766	35,310
1969 World Meeting	–	13,736
Foreign Literature Aid	1,643	2,989
Film, Film Strip, Display Boards	1,403	1,326
Total Expense	<u>\$892,020</u>	<u>\$675,254</u>
NET INCOME (LOSS) FOR YEAR (Exhibit C)	<u>(132,248)</u>	<u>8,741</u>

NET INCOME (EXPENSE) BY FUNCTION

World Service Office – Group Fund	\$ (56,889)	\$ (21,733)
Publishing – A.A. World Services, Inc.	74,134	91,023
General Fund – General Service Board	(149,493)	(60,549)

CHANGES IN OTHER FUNDS – 1970

	<u>Convention</u>	<u>Pension</u>	<u>Reserve</u>
Balance, January 1, 1970	\$ 14,674	\$ 13,555	\$300,099
Book Discounts		40,949	
Contribution by A.A. Grapevine, Inc.		3,500	
Investment Income	(1,846)	770	14,005
Transfers (to) from Other Funds	(6,500)		(60,000)
Less: Current Funding Costs		(36,017)	
Actuary Fee		(1,674)	
Refund of Convention Deposits	(6,328)		
Balance, December 31, 1970	<u>–0–</u>	<u>\$ 21,083</u>	<u>\$254,104</u>

() Denotes red figures

Amounts in these financial statements under the heading "Service Office" combine the accounts of the General Service Board of A.A. Inc., and of A.A. World Services, Inc. The latter corporation publishes books and pamphlets and pays a portion of the expense of the General Service Office, while the accounts of The General Service Board are further subdivided into Funds, as follows:

The RESERVE FUND, which was established in 1954 – by transfer from the General Fund of cash then on deposit in savings accounts – for the purpose of accumulating a prudent operating reserve. Its use may be authorized by the Board of Trustees on recommendation of the Finance and Budgetary Committee.

The DEFERRED PENSION FUND, which was established in 1965 to receive moneys for the benefit of employees of A.A. World Services, Inc. and The A.A. Grapevine, Inc. prior to transfer to the Trustee of the A.A. Retirement Trust.

(continued on p. 42)

INCOME STATEMENT

The A.A. Grapevine, Inc.

YEAR ENDED DECEMBER 31, 1970

	1970	1969
INCOME – FROM SUBSCRIPTIONS AND OTHER SALES	<u>\$243,356.54</u>	<u>\$224,989.20</u>
EDITORIAL AND PRINTING		
Salaries	35,572.73	31,954.48
Printing	52,278.53	48,281.71
Mailing	29,479.02	26,981.74
Other printing costs	1,459.19	1,537.24
Calendar costs	6,757.58	7,170.49
Best Cartoons	2,752.61	—
Rent	6,925.37	5,396.36
Telephone	1,182.88	1,029.13
Office supplies and expense	2,526.60	1,502.49
Other editorial expenses	2,971.19	3,515.48
Office cleaning	869.03	600.00
Total	<u>\$142,774.73</u>	<u>\$127,969.12</u>
CIRCULATION AND BUSINESS		
Salaries	\$ 43,759.36	\$ 37,979.43
Stationery and supplies	2,449.01	2,470.99
Rent	6,925.32	5,396.35
Telephone	1,102.43	826.92
Other office expense	1,188.05	3,684.42
Selling expense	7,785.34	5,885.45
Postage	5,166.11	4,350.23
Office cleaning	869.00	600.00
Bad debts	773.10	417.90
Total	<u>\$ 70,017.72</u>	<u>\$ 61,611.69</u>
GENERAL AND ADMINISTRATIVE		
Insurance	\$ 3,596.44	\$ 3,107.15
Legal and accounting	3,600.00	3,700.00
Taxes	3,822.96	4,839.61
Meetings and conferences	1,353.78	518.65
Moving expenses	1,987.20	—
Office construction costs	5,217.00	—
Furniture and equipment	2,201.00	546.65
Contribution to Retirement Plan	3,500.00	3,500.00
Total	<u>\$ 25,278.38</u>	<u>\$ 16,212.06</u>
TOTAL COSTS AND EXPENSES	<u>\$238,070.83</u>	<u>\$205,792.87</u>
INCOME FROM OPERATIONS	<u>\$ 5,285.71</u>	<u>\$ 19,196.33</u>
Add: Interest on savings accounts	<u>8,709.77</u>	<u>5,876.87</u>
NET INCOME FOR YEAR (Exhibit C)	<u>\$ 13,995.48</u>	<u>\$ 25,073.20</u>

(continued from p. 41)

The GROUP CONTRIBUTION FUND, which was established in 1941 to receive contributions from A.A. Groups and members to be used solely for the expenses of the General Service Office, and, subsequently, for the costs of the General Service Office, and, subsequently, for the costs of the General Service Conference.

The GENERAL FUND, which is comprised of those assets not included in either of the other funds and which may be used for any of the purposes for which the corporation was formed.

The CONVENTION GUARANTY and OPERATING FUNDS were established in prior years to: (1) segregate funds set aside from the GENERAL FUND and by other subscribers to underwrite a possible deficit of the 35th Anniversary Convention held in Miami in July 1970; and (2) to record income and expenses of the Convention. Both accounts were closed in 1970 by refunding the Guaranty deposits and transferring the net Convention income of \$15,809 to the General Fund.

(continued on p. 43)

COMBINED BALANCE SHEET

The General Service Office and The A.A. Grapevine, Inc.

YEAR ENDED DECEMBER 31, 1970

	December 31, 1970		December 31, 1969	
	Service Office	A.A. Grapevine	Service Office	A.A. Grapevine
OPERATING FUNDS				
ASSETS				
Cash	\$105,285	\$ 33,674	\$168,172	\$ 28,525
Savings Accounts and Certificates		17,790		120,951
Marketable Securities		90,447		24,938
Accounts Receivable	18,504	6,160	15,418	2,663
Due from Grapevine, Convention Operating and Reserve Funds	39,724		37,878	
Inventories	124,500	8,602	106,700	977
Prepaid Expenses	26,754	4,314	25,240	4,551
Total Assets	\$314,767	\$160,987	\$353,408	\$182,605
DEDUCT LIABILITIES				
Accounts and Accruals Payable	20,288	14,729	27,659	19,487
Due Pension Fund	3,098		2,848	
Prepaid Subscriptions, Unearned Income		97,683		90,539
Reserve for Retirement Plan Payments		7,000		7,000
Reserve for EDP Installation			18,500	
Total Liabilities	\$ 23,386	\$119,412	\$ 49,007	\$117,026
NET WORTH				
Balance, January 1	304,401	65,579	268,060	52,506
Net Income (loss) for Year (Exhibits A and B)	(132,248)	13,996	8,741	25,073
Dividend (paid) or received		(38,000)	12,000	(12,000)
Transfers from Reserve and Convention Funds	66,500		15,600	
Transfer from Reserve for EDP Installation	14,728			
Total Net Worth	\$291,381	\$ 41,575	\$304,401	\$ 65,579
NET WORTH BY FUNCTION OR FUND				
World Service Office – Group Fund (Note B)	\$ 11,123		\$ 11,123	
Publishing – A.A. World Services, Inc. (Note A)	223,484		184,622	
General Fund – G.S.B. (Notes A and B)	56,774		108,656	
Total Operating Funds – as above	\$291,381		\$304,401	
Reserve Fund	254,104		300,099	
Deferred Pension Fund	21,083		13,555	
Convention Guaranty Fund	—		14,674	
Total Net Worth	\$566,568		\$632,729	
RESERVE AND DEFERRED PENSION FUNDS				
	Reserve	Pension		
Cash	\$ (881)			
Savings Accounts and Certificates	33,169	\$ 26,988		
Due from A.A.W.S. and General Fund		3,098		
U.S. Treasury obligations	170,167			
Government Agency and Corporate Bonds	79,320			
Accrued Interest	4,053			
Less: Due General Fund	(31,724)			
A.A. Retirement Trust		(9,003)		
BALANCE, DECEMBER 31	\$254,104	\$ 21,083		

() Denotes Red Figures

(continued from p. 42)

In these statements, the net worth and net operating results of A.A. World Services, Inc. are referred to as Publishing, of the Group Contribution Fund as World Service, and of the other Funds by their names.

NOTE A – After transfers of \$50,000 in 1970, and \$85,000 in 1969 from Publishing to General Fund.

NOTE B – Transfers of \$56,900 in 1970 and \$21,700 in 1969 were made by the General Fund to the Group Contribution Fund to make up deficits in Group contributions in those years.

These financial statements and above notes have been prepared by the independent certified public accountants from the figures contained in their reports on the three separate corporations.

1971 CONFERENCE MEMBERS *

Trustees, A.A.W.S. Directors, G.S.O. & Grapevine Staffs

NONALCOHOLIC TRUSTEES

John L. Norris, M.D. (Chairman)
Box 251
New London, N.H. 03257

Austin H. MacCormick (1st Vice Chm.)
Osborne Association
114 East 30th Street
New York, New York 10016

Dr. John D. Bealer**
3639 Emerson Circle
Bethlehem, Pa. 18017

Milton Maxwell, Ph.D.**
86 Mitchell Avenue
Piscataway, N. J. 08854

Travis E. Dancey, M.D.
4015 Wilson Avenue
Montreal 28, Quebec, Canada

Vincent Dole, M.D.
Rockefeller University
67th St. & York Ave.
New York, New York 10021

Arthur Miles (Treasurer)
212 Poplar Street
Floral Park, N. Y. 11001

ALCOHOLIC TRUSTEES

Ralph Ahringer**
73 Plymouth Drive North
Glen Head, New York 11545

Jack R. Meagher**
1015 Whites Road
Kalamazoo, Michigan 49001

Donald G. Austin**
P.O. Drawer 1
Chappell Hill Farm
Chappell Hill, Texas 77426

Tom W. Moore**
Box 458
Pulaski, Tennessee 38478

William Coogan
40 Court Street
Boston, Mass. 02108

Stephen Owen, Sr.
229 Hollywood Crossing
Lawrence, L.I., N.Y. 11519

Don Farrell
108 So. 53rd Street
Omaha, Nebraska 68132

Robert G. Pearson
1 Jones Park
Riverside, Conn. 06878

Thomas D. Grafton**
1 Iroquois Bay
St. Boniface 6, Manitoba, Canada

Bayard Pope, Jr.
B.B.D. & O.
383 Madison Avenue
New York, New York

George Grimstad**
Route 3
Sedona, Arizona 86336

John Rae
Heatherview Manor, Apt. 7
Swift Current, Sask., Canada

James E. Hiers
608 Cleermont Drive, S.E.
Huntsville, Alabama 35801

Robert Roy**
75 Marengere Street - Apt. 6
Hull, Quebec, Canada

A.A. GRAPEVINE DIRECTORS

Milton Maxwell, Ph.D. (Chairman & President)
Jack Morley (Editor)
Paula Carpenter (Vice President, Secretary)
George Gordon, Ph.D. (Treasurer)
Austin MacCormick
Charles Edgar
Robert Pearson
Ralph Ahringer
Pete Smyth

A.A. WORLD SERVICES DIRECTORS

Robert E. Hitchins (Chairman)
Bayard Pope, Jr. (1st Vice Chairman)
Midge McFadden (2nd Vice Chairman)
Stephen Owen, Sr. (Treasurer)
Walter Murphy
Robert Pearson
Robert Macpherson
Ann Macfarlane (Secretary)

GRAPEVINE STAFF

Paula Carpenter
Jack Morley

GENERAL SERVICE OFFICE STAFF

Robert E. Hitchins
Cora Louise Belford
Beth Kuhlmann
Ann Macfarlane
Midge McFadden
Waneta New
Eleanor Newman
Hazel Rice
Valerie Seyffert
Mary Ellen Uribe

Al Cryan, Manager, Shipping
Rose Failla, Manager, Records
Kleina Jones, Office Manager
Madeline Whitlock, Supervisor, Clerical/Steno
Nell Wing, Production Editor, Box 4-5-9

Dennis Manders, Controller
Charles Columbia, Supervisor, Accounting
Wilbur A. Smith (Ind. C.P.A.)
Owen J. Flanagan, C.P.A.
Niles Peebles, Writing Consultant

Two Observers from: Public Information Committee
Two Observers from: Literature Committee
Two Observers from: Grapevine Editorial Board
One Observer from: Professional Relations

*Members of Conference other than area delegates

**Elected April, 1971

TRUSTEES OF THE GENERAL SERVICE BOARD

Nonalcoholic Trustees

JOHN L. NORRIS, M.D. . . . is chairman of the General Service Board and the Service Conference. He was elected to the Board in January, 1951. Before his retirement, "Dr. Jack" was the associate medical director of the Eastman Kodak Company in Rochester, New York . . . He is chairman of the Governor's Committee on Alcoholism and a former president of the Industrial Medicine Association. As his record in and out of A.A. suggests, he has contributed much to the understanding and rehabilitation of alcoholics.

JOHN D. BEALER, M.D. . . . elected to the Board in April, 1971; is assistant medical director of Bethlehem Steel Corporation, Bethlehem, Pennsylvania. He has long been interested in the problem of alcoholism in industry and is a member of the American Medical Society of Alcoholism and a director of the National Council on Alcoholism.

TRAVIS EUGENE DANCEY, M.D. . . . elected to the Board in January, 1965. Before his retirement Dr. Dancey was chief of Service/Psychiatry at Queen Mary Veterans Hospital and senior psychiatrist at Montreal General Hospital. He has been a good friend of the Fellowship since the formation of the first A.A. group in Quebec. He is the first nonalcoholic trustee to serve from Canada. Dr. Dancey serves on the Trustees' Nominating and Policy Committees.

VINCENT P. DOLE, M.D. . . . elected to the General Service Board in April, 1965. He is a professor and senior physician at the Rockefeller Institute Hospital. Dr. Dole developed a method used in the treatment of narcotic addiction; he is active in organizations dealing with this health problem. He serves on the Trustees' Policy Committee.

AUSTIN H. MacCORMICK . . . is 1st vice chairman of the General Service Board — was elected to the Board in April, 1961. An early friend of A.A., he had served on the Board previously from October, 1949 to April, 1951. He left in 1951 to become professor of criminology at the University of California in Berkeley, and on his retirement in 1960, returned to New York as executive director of the Osborne Association, Inc. He is a director of the A.A. Grapevine, a member of its Corporate and Editorial Boards, serves as chairman of the Trustees' Literature Committee, and is a member of the Policy Committee.

MILTON A. MAXWELL, Ph.D. . . . elected to the Board in April, 1971; he is executive director of the Rutgers Summer School of Alcohol Studies and professor of sociology in the Center of Alcohol Studies at Rutgers. He has published many research papers dealing with alcohol, alcoholics and Alcoholics Anonymous. His most recent research has focused on the relations between professionals and Alcoholics Anonymous. He serves on the Trustees' Long-Range Planning and Professional Relations Committees.

ARTHUR J. MILES . . . was elected to the Board in April, 1970. He is a senior vice president of the Dime Savings Bank of Brooklyn and on the Board of Trustees of the American Institute of Banking and the Cultural Institutions Retirement System. He is also a member of the New York Society of Security Analysts and the National Association of Business Economists. He resides in Floral Park, L.I. with his wife and two children; serves as chairman of the Trustees' Finance and Retirement Committees.

A.A. Trustees

RALPH W. AHRINGER . . . elected in April, 1971, is a director of the Grapevine Corporate Board and member of the Trustees' Nominating and Literature Committees. Ralph had his last drink in 1954. He is a former delegate to the General Service Conference and former chairman and treasurer of the General Service Committee, as well as former president of New York Intergroup. Most recently he was chairman of the Intergroup Advisory Committee. He is sales manager and advertising manager of Sabin Robbins Paper Company.

DONALD G. AUSTIN . . . elected as trustee from the Southwest region in April, 1971. Don had his last drink in 1953. He is a former chairman of the Texas State A.A. Convention and committee member from the Southwest Texas area. Also vice chairman of the Texas Commission on Alcoholism, and a member of the Board of the Houston Council on Alcoholism.

BILL COOGAN . . . was elected to the General Service Board in April, 1969 as trustee from the Northeast Region. Since his last drink in 1958 he has served in many capacities from group treasurer to area delegate. Bill practices law in Boston, Mass. He is a member of the Harvard Alumni and the Boston College Alumni Associations. He is also a member of the American Bar Association and the Massachusetts Trial

Lawyers Association. He serves on the Trustees' Policy and Nominating Committees.

DONALD F. FARRELL . . . was elected to the General Service Board in April, 1968, as trustee from the West Central Region. He had his last drink in 1943. After helping start A.A. in Des Moines, he became one of the original members in Omaha. A former delegate, he is active in institutions work and court programs for alcoholics. Don owns and operates a photographic business. He is a member of the Trustees' Policy and Nominating Committees.

THOMAS D. GRAFTON . . . elected trustee at large from Canada in April, 1971. He had his last drink in 1960. Active in institutions, intergroup and general service work. Tom is a former delegate from Manitoba and former chairman of the Manitoba General Service Committee. A member of the legal firm of Monnin, Grafton and Company, Tom is also a director of the Canadian Mental Health Association.

GEORGE GRIMSTAD . . . elected as trustee from the Pacific region in April, 1971. He is a former delegate from Chicago, Illinois, now living in Arizona, and was one of the founders of the General Service Committee and Intergroup in Chicago. George had his last drink in 1950. He is a manufacturer's representative and owns and operates an Industrial Supply Company. He is also president of Northern Arizona Recovery Centers.

TRUSTEES' COMMITTEE

A.A. TRUSTEES (from p. 45)

JAMES E. HIERS . . . was elected to the General Service Board as trustee at large from the United States in April, 1970. He had his last drink in 1951 and was a Panel 7 delegate to the General Service Conference. Active in numerous charitable and civic associations, Jim is the administrative management officer for NASA of Huntsville, Alabama, and serves on the Trustees' Finance, Policy and Professional Relations Committees.

JACK R. MEAGHER . . . elected as trustee from the East Central region in April, 1971. He had his last drink in 1949. A former delegate from Western Michigan, Jack also served as chairman of the State Conference and Western Michigan General Service Committee. He is director of the Computer Center and associate professor of mathematics at Western Michigan University.

TOM W. MOORE . . . elected in April, 1971, as trustee from the Southeast region. He had his last drink in 1950. He is a former delegate from Tennessee as well as chairman of the state committee. A lawyer, Tom is senior partner of Moore, Henry, Henry, Lewis & Cain and immediate past president of the Pulaski-Giles County Bar Association. He also serves as trustee for a college and a charitable institution.

STEVE OWEN, SR. . . . was elected to the General Service Board, April, 1969 and began serving the end of July. He has held various positions in his home group in Long Island. He served as Intergroup treasurer in 1962 and 1963 and he had his last drink in 1960. Steve recently retired as president of the Beacon Manufacturing Company, a textile firm. He is treasurer of A.A. World Services, Inc. and a member of the Trustees' Policy, Finance, Literature Committees and is chairman of the Professional Relations Committee.

ROBERT PEARSON . . . was elected to the General Service Board in July, 1968. He had his last drink in 1961. He is a director of the Grapevine Corporate Board as well as of A.A.W.S., Inc. He was chairman of the Public Information Committee of New York Intergroup and is a former president of the Fairfield County (Conn.) Council on Alcoholism. He is an executive with The Council of Better Business Bureau, Inc. Bob is chairman of the Trustees' Nominating Committee and also serves on the Policy Committee and Long-Range Planning Committee.

BAYARD POPE . . . was elected to the General Service Board as a service trustee in January, 1968. He had his last drink in 1959. He is presently chairman of the Trustees' Public Information Committee. He was a member of the Steering Committee and chairman of the P.I. Committee of the Intergroup Association of New York, and is on the Executive Committee of the Community Council on Alcoholism. He is vice president and a director of Batten, Barton, Durstine and Osborn; Bayard also serves on the Trustees' Policy Committee.

JOHN RAE . . . was elected to the General Service Board April, 1969, from the Western Canada region. He has been sober since 1957, and has been active in group and area affairs. He served as General Service delegate, 1960-1961. John is the manager of the Medical Clinic, in Swift Current, Saskatchewan, Canada. He serves on the Trustees' Policy, Professional Relations and Literature Committees.

ROBERT ROY . . . elected in April, 1971, as trustee from the Eastern Canada region, he had his last drink in April, 1959. A former delegate from Quebec, Bob is a co-founder of "La Vigne," a French-language publication for A.A. members, and was chairman of the Quebec General Service Committee, as well as secretary of Montreal Intergroup. He is an auditor with the office of Audit Services Bureau, Government of Canada.

FINANCE & BUDGETARY

Arthur J. Miles, chairman
Rollie Davidson
George Gordon
Jim Hiers
Robert E. Hitchins
Stephen Owen, Sr.
Maurice Reilly, Jr.
Ruth Weir, co-chairman
Wilbur Smith, C.P.A. (ex officio)
Owen Flanagan, C.P.A.
Dennis Manders, secretary

Investment Advisory Committee

Arthur J. Miles, chairman
Robert E. Hitchins
Chester Rude, adviser
Dennis Manders, secretary

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Stephen C. Owen, Sr., co-chairman
Ralph Ahringer
Arthur Anderson
Joel Bennett
Eric Bergman
Robert E. Hitchins
Robert Macpherson
Jack Morley
Barry Leach, consultant
John Rae
Mary Elizabeth Sullivan
Janet Graves, consultant
Hazel Rice, secretary

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John Rae
Maurice Reilly, Jr.
Hazel Rice
Ruth Weir
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Jim Cassidy
Jerry Danzig
Janet Graves
John Henderson
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Rex Moody
Walter Murphy
Tom Rosenberg
Eleanor Newman, secretary

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Ralph Ahringer
William Coogan
Travis Dancey, M.D.
Rollie Davidson
Donald Farrell
Robert E. Hitchins
Walter Murphy
Katharine Prince
Waneta New, secretary

LONG-RANGE PLANNING

Dr. John Norris, chairman
Milton Maxwell
Robert Pearson

Robert McAteer, Panel 21
(Replacing Margaret C.)
Robert E. Hitchins, secretary

NOTE: The above list of Committee Members was in effect at the time of the Conference.

1971 CONFERENCE COMMITTEES

Agenda-Admissions

George Bohannon, Kansas
Mike Hayvren, S.W. Quebec (Eng.)
Terry Penton, Manitoba
Stanley Plahn, N.W. Wisc. & Upper Mich.
Betty Vaughan, Oregon
Charles Webb, N.W. Ohio & S.E. Mich.

Don Byrd, E. Missouri
**Richard Harter, N. Indiana
Shorty Hofstedt, Washington
Robert McAteer, W. Virginia

Ex Officio

Art Kolkmann, So. California
George Stumpp, S.E. New York

Secretary: Waneta New

Conference Report & Charter

Sam Faucett, So. Indiana
Ralph Fox, Nebraska
Walter Hood, Tennessee

*Bob Bernelle, No. Interior Calif.
Joe Cawley, Chicago, Ill.
C.W. Gilbert, Arkansas
E.P. MacDonald, N.S./Nfld./Lab.
Lenore Marple, E. Penn.
Dick Toussaint, Nevada
**Bill Valli, B.C./Yukon

Ex Officio

Carl LeBlanc, N.W. Ontario

Secretary: Nell Wing

Finance

*Fleurange Laforest, S.W. Quebec (Fr.)
Hal Cornelius, San Diego, Calif.
Tom O'Neal, N.W. Texas
Lambert Seemans, Delaware
Bud Williams, Kentucky

Jack Crenshaw, Alabama
Adam Holzhauer, S. Illinois
Warren McGinley, So. Minnesota
**John L. Nolan, Colorado
William Rennie, Connecticut

Ex Officio

Neal Lancaster, Arkansas

Secretary: Dennis Manders

Grapevine

Roland Carlson, No. Illinois
Doris Carter, S.W. Texas
Ray Redfern, Montana
Helen Stevens, New Hampshire
Stan Biggar, N.B./P.E.I.

**Bob Allen, Hawaii
William Baker, N. New Jersey
Hank Burgess, Iowa
Dr. Mel Le Gard, E. Ontario
Betty Ridenhour, No. Carolina

Ex Officio

Charles Darien, C. Michigan

Secretary: Paula Carpenter

Institutions

Floyd D'Arcy, W. Michigan
Cecil Hamilton, So. Carolina
Chuck Luke, South Dakota
Ellery Stowell, So. Coastal Cal.
Robert Wilson, N.Y. - H.M.B.

**Bob Buck, W. Pennsylvania
Gloria Carter, Louisiana
George Stewart, Utah
Shirley Susevich, N.E. Ohio
Gus Wright, W. Missouri

Secretary: Mary Ellen Uribe

Literature

Margaret Carlson, W. Mass.
Roy Clark, Vermont
Herman Fink, Wyoming
John O'Keefe, Maryland
Raul Pelegrina, Puerto Rico

Jim Allen, No. Coastal Calif.
William Armstrong, Jr., N.E. Texas
Ken Church, S.E. Michigan
Howard Robinson, Central & S.E. Ohio
**John E. Ryall, S.E. New York

Ex Officio

Mac Blair, Virginia
Evelyn Bottom, Colorado

Secretary: Hazel Rice

Policy

Luke Borgert, S.W. Ohio & No. Ky.
R.T. Douglas, Mississippi
Betty Holmes, Arizona
Arnold Jaeger, North Dakota
John Mills, So. New Jersey
*Jim Hoey, Alberta

Patricia Glenn, So. Florida
**Neal Matlock, S.E. Texas
Jack Brownyard, Central N.Y.
Hector Lavictore, N.E. Ontario

Ex Officio

Mabel Plyler, Louisiana

Secretary: Midge McFadden

Public Information

James Campbell, W. New York
Willard Ford, Maine
Pat Mauer, Alaska
Edith Stoner, Idaho
Clarence Berg, No. Minnesota

Carl V. Binam, So. California
Sam Inman, No. Florida
**Hal Marley, Washington, D.C.
George McMullen, Central Michigan
Barry Weiss, Northwestern Ontario

Ex Officio

Junior Anderson, E. Mass.
Monroe Brubaker, E. Penn.
John Low, N.E. Ohio

Secretary: Eleanor Newman
Acting Secretary: Cora Louise Belford

Conference Committee on Trustees

Jimmy Dodson, New Mexico
John Fitzpatrick, Rhode Island
Karl Forbes, Saskatchewan
Bob Ross, Georgia
Gil Wiggins, W. Ontario

**Joseph Bach, So. Wisconsin
Stuart Nelson, E. Mass.
Joe Bristow, Virginia
Earl Paquet, N.E. Quebec
Jim Dambold, Oklahoma

Ex Officio

Ed Allen, Eastern Ont.

Secretary: Waneta New
Acting Secretary: Ann Macfarlane

1971 CONFERENCE AREA DELEGATES

STATE	PANEL
ALABAMA & N.W. FLORIDA	(21) Jack Crenshaw, Washington Bldg., Montgomery 36104
ALASKA	(20) Pat Mauer, 2804 Borland Drive, Anchorage 99503
ARIZONA	(20) Betty Holmes, 4123 West Va. Ave., Phoenix 85009
ARKANSAS	(21) C.W. Gilbert, 213 West 10th Street, Dewitt 72042
CALIFORNIA	(21) Southern - Carl V. Binam, 3490 Hadley Way, Santa Maria 93454 (21) Northern Coastal - Jim Allen, 134 Nevada Street, San Francisco 94110 (20) *Northern Interior - Bob Bernelle, 3701 Irish Road, Redding 96001 (20) San Diego - Hal Cornelius, 222 E. Quintard, Chula Vista 92011 (20) Southern Coastal - Ellery Stowell, 4801 Surrey Drive, Corona del Mar 92625
COLORADO	(21) John L. Nolan, 317 West Main St., Sterling 80751
CONNECTICUT	(21) William Rennicke, 95 Fitch Street, North Haven 06473
DELAWARE	(20) Lambert Seemans, P.O. Box 75, Odessa 19730
D.C.	(21) Hal Marley, 5111 8th Road South, Arlington, Virginia 22204
FLORIDA	(21) Northern - Sam Inman, 7703 Hare Avenue, Jacksonville 32211 (21) Southern - Patricia M. Glenn, Box 1031, Bradenton 33505
GEORGIA	(20) Bob' Ross, P.O. Box 10497, Atlanta 30310
HAWAII	(21) Bob Allen, Apt. 12-A Regency, 4340 Pahoa Avenue, Honolulu 96816
IDAHO	(20) Edith Stoner, 403 Second Street, Idaho Falls 83401
ILLINOIS	(21) Chicago - Joe Cawley, 7616 Vine, River Forest (20) Northern - Roland Carlson, 409 Robert Avenue, Rockford 61107 (21) Southern - Adam Holzhauer, 201 North Penfield, Rantoul 61866
INDIANA	(21) Northern - Richard Harter, 201 Red River Road, New Castle 47362

What Do Panel Numbers Mean? Delegates to each Conference are made up of two "panels." One is even-numbered and includes those elected to start serving in an even year. The other is odd-numbered and includes those elected to start serving in an odd year. This 21st Conference is made up of Panel 20 -- the old delegates -- and Panel 21 -- the new delegates.

PANEL	STATE
	(20) Southern - Sam Faucett, Box 772, Evansville 47701
IOWA	(21) Henry Burgess, 1340 W. Ridgeway, Waterloo 50701
KANSAS	(20) George Bohannon, 3007 California, Topeka 66605
KENTUCKY	(20) Winston "Bud" Williams, 2231 Peas- lee Road, Shively 40216
LOUISIANA	(21) Gloria Carter, 115 Meadow Lane, Lafayette 70501
MAINE	(20) Willard Ford, P.O. Box 2, Tenants Harbor 04860
MARYLAND	(20) John O'Keefe, 712 Jackson Street, Salisbury 21801
MASSACHUSETTS	(21) Eastern - Stuart Nelson, 293 Elm Street, West Bridgewater 02379 (20) Western - Margaret Carlson, 13 Ruth Drive, Wilbraham 01095
MICHIGAN	(21) Central - George McMullen, 1315 Hayes Street, Saginaw 48602 (21) Southeast - Ken Church, 23718 Wilnot Street, East Detroit 48021
	(20) Western - Floyd D'Arcy, R. No. 2, Box 141, Big Rapids 49307
MINNESOTA	(20) Northern - Clarence Berg, Box 208, Fergus Falls, 56537
	(21) Southern - Warren McGinley, 1073 Hague Avenue, St. Paul 55104
MISSISSIPPI	(20) R.T. Douglas, Box 4773, Jackson 39216
MISSOURI	(21) Eastern - Don Byrd, Box 389, Rolla 65401 (21) Western - Gus Wright, 2928 Mason, Independence 64052
MONTANA	(20) Ray C. Redfern, 2532 South Mon- tana, Butte 59701

Delegates (cont'd)

STATE	PANEL	STATE	PANEL
NEBRASKA	(20) Ralph Fox, 1601 Euclid, Lincoln 68502	SOUTH CAROLINA	(20) Cecil Hamilton, P.O. Box 140, Walterboro 29488
NEVADA	(21) Dick Toussaint, 635 Pecos Way, Las Vegas 89109	SOUTH DAKOTA	(20) Chuck Luke, 1609 Burleigh, Yankton 57078
NEW HAMPSHIRE	(20) Helen Stevens, P.O. Box 31, Greenfield 03047	TENNESSEE	(20) Walter Hood, 311 Hamilton Road S.W., Knoxville 37920
NEW JERSEY	(21) Northern - William Baker, 215 Clinton Place, Hackensack 07602 (20) Southern - John Mills, 208 White Horse Pike, Oaklyn Manor Apts., Oaklyn	TEXAS	(21) Northeast - William G. Armstrong, Jr., Box 295, Gainesville 76240 (20) Northwest - Tom O'Neal, 4722 Oregon Trail, Amarillo 79109 (21) Southeast - Neal Matlock, 3522 Avenue "L", Galveston 77550 (20) Southwest - Doris Carter, 11905 Arabian Trail, Austin 78759
NEW MEXICO	(20) Jimmy Dodson, P.O. Box 52, Peralta 87042	UTAH	(21) George Stewart, 2467 Beverly St., Salt Lake City 84106
NEW YORK	(21) Central - Jack Brownyard, 2220 Main Street East, Rochester 14609 Hudson/Mohawk/Berkshire - John E. Ryall, 32 Garden Avenue, Carle Place 11514 (20) Western - James Campbell, 243 East Amherst Street, Buffalo 14214	VERMONT	(20) Roy Clark, Box 491, Briston 05443
NORTH CAROLINA	(21) Betty Ridenhour, 32 White Street, N.W., Concord 28025	VIRGINIA	(21) Joe Bristow, Box 197, Saluda 23149
NORTH DAKOTA	(20) Arnold Jaeger, 1716 4th Street, Bismarck 58501	WASHINGTON	(21) Harold (Shorty) Hofstedt, 105 So. Williams, Kennewick 99336
OHIO	(21) Central & Southeast - Howard Robinson, 904 Adair Avenue, Zanesville 43701 (21) Northeast - Shirley Susevich, 1868 Redbird Road, North Madison 44057 (20) N.W. Ohio & S.E. Michigan - Charles I. Webb, 4030 West Bancroft Street, Toledo 43606 (20) So./Southwest Ohio & Northern Kentucky - Luke Borgert, 328 Leland Avenue, Dayton 45417	WEST VIRGINIA	(21) Robert McAteer, 1522 Court Ave., St. Albans 25177
OKLAHOMA	(21) Jim Dambold, P.O. Box 248, Lawton 73501	WISCONSIN	(20) N. Wisconsin & Upper Michigan - Stanley Plahn, Clayton 54004 (21) Southern - Joseph E. Bach, 2861 North 84th St., Milwaukee 53222
OREGON	(20) Mrs. Betty Vaughan, 17605 S.E. Roethe Place, Milwaukie 97222	WYOMING	(20) Herman Fink, 740 Shoshone, Lovell 82431
PENNSYLVANIA	(21) Eastern - Mrs. Lenore Marple, Gov. Sproul, Apt. 307, Donaldson Manor, Broomall 19008 (21) Western - Bob Buck, 4116 Page Street, Erie 16510	PUERTO RICO	(20) Raul Pelegrina, Box 151, Cantano 00632
RHODE ISLAND	(20) Joseph Fitzpatrick, 776 Hartford Avenue, Johnston 02919	PROVINCE CANADA	PANEL
		ALBERTA	(20) *Jim Hoey, 408 Trafford Drive, N.W., Calgary
		BRITISH COLUMBIA/YUKON	(21) Bill Valli, 2459 Rosewood Avenue, Kamloops, B.C.
		MANITOBA	(20) Terry Penton, 132 28th Street, Brandon
		NEW BRUNSWICK/PRINCE EDWARD ISL.	(20) Stan Biggar, 19 Kensington Road, Charlottetown, P.E.I.
		NOVA SCOTIA/NEW-FOUNDLAND/LABRADOR	(21) E.P. MacDonald, Box 7131, St. Johns, Newfoundland

Delegates (cont'd)

PROVINCE	STATE	PROVINCE	STATE
ONTARIO	(21) Eastern - Dr. Mel LeGard, 2347 Weston Road, Weston	QUEBEC	(20) Southwestern (English) - Mike Hayvren, 614 6th Avenue, Lachine
	(21) Northeastern - Hector Lavictoire, Box 388, Sturgeon Falls		(20) *Southwestern (French) - Fleurange Laforest, 36 Deslauriers, Pierrefonds
	(21) Northwestern - Barry Weiss, 420 Heather Cr., Thunder Bay, Station F.		(21) Northeast - Earl Paquet, 611 Rue Oustedt, Arvida
	(20) Western - Gil Wiggins, R.R. No. 3, Fenwick	SASKATCHEWAN	(20) Karl Forbes, 2417 Clarence Avenue, Saskatoon

The Language of the Heart

Why, at this particular point in history, has God chosen to communicate His healing grace to so many of us? Every aspect of this global unfoldment can be related to a single crucial word. The word is "communication." There has been a life-saving communication among ourselves, with the world around us, and with God.

From the beginning, communication in A.A. has been no ordinary transmission of helpful ideas and attitudes. Because of our kinship in suffering, and because our common means of deliverance are effective for ourselves only when constantly carried to others, our channels of contact have always been charged with the language of the heart.

— Bill W.

From:

"As Bill Sees It"

